

Current Affairs MCQs PDF - January, 2026



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1. Which state has become the first in India to establish a national Artificial Intelligence (AI) research institution?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Gujarat

Gujarat Government led by Chief Minister (CM) Bhupendra Patel approved the Indian Artificial Intelligence Research Organization (IAIRO) at Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City), Gandhinagar. Gujarat became the first state in India to establish a national Artificial Intelligence (AI) research institution under a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model. IAIRO will start operations on 1 January 2026 as a non-profit under Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013. It will follow a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model via State Government, Central Government and Indian Pharmaceutical Alliance (IPA).

2. As per recent report, India recently surpassed which country to become the world's fourth-largest economy?

- [A] Japan
- [B] Germany
- [C] Russia
- [D] China

Answer: Japan

As per recent report by Indian government, India surpassed Japan to become the world's fourth-largest economy with Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of USD 4.18 trillion. India is expected to overtake Germany to become the third-largest economy by 2030 with projected GDP of USD 7.3 trillion. India remains the world's fastest-growing major economy despite global trade uncertainties. Real GDP grew 8.2% in Quarter 2 of 2025-26, rising steadily from previous quarters. Growth is driven mainly by strong private consumption and domestic demand. The United States (US) ranks first and China second in global economy size.

3. Grandmaster Arjun Erigaisi won which medal at the World Blitz Championship 2025?

- [A] Gold medal
- [B] Silver medal
- [C] Bronze medal
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Bronze medal



Grandmaster Arjun Erigaisi lost the semifinal to Uzbek player Nodirbek Abdusattorov at the World Blitz Championship in Doha. He secured the bronze medal in the tournament. Defending champion Magnus Carlsen reached the final after defeating Fabiano Caruana 3-1 in the other semifinal. Prime Minister Narendra Modi congratulated Arjun Erigaisi for his bronze medal in the Blitz Championship and his recent FIDE Rapid Chess Championship bronze.

4. Which state has approved Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AI-ML) Policy in January 2026?

- [A] Rajasthan
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Madhya Pradesh

Answer: Rajasthan

Rajasthan Cabinet approved the Rajasthan Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AI-ML) Policy-2026 to position the state as a hub for technology-driven investment and innovation. The policy aims to make public services faster, transparent, citizen-centric, and enhance administrative efficiency through responsible, ethical, and secure AI and ML use. The policy focuses on transparent, accountable, fair, and privacy-protected AI systems, reducing bias, ensuring data security, making AI decisions explainable and auditable, and addressing AI-related cybercrimes. An Artificial Intelligence Centre of Excellence will be created to support research, innovation, and capacity building.

5. What is the IUCN conservation status of Chinese Pangolin that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Critically Endangered
- [B] Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Critically Endangered

Researchers from the Nature Conservation Foundation (NCF) have shown that local ecological knowledge of the Adi community can improve efforts to track the critically endangered Chinese pangolin. Chinese pangolin (*Manis pentadactyla*) is a small, nocturnal mammal fully covered in protective keratin scales. It inhabits subtropical, tropical, and deciduous forests and is distributed across southern China, Taiwan, Hong Kong, Hainan, parts of Southeast Asia including Myanmar, Laos, Thailand, and Vietnam, as well as northern India, Nepal, and Bhutan. The species has been listed as Critically Endangered on the IUCN Red List.

6. Foster Parent Scheme (Palak Mata-Pita Yojana), that was recently in news, was launched by which state government in 2009–10?

- [A] Punjab
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Odisha

**Answer: Gujarat**

The Foster Parent Scheme (Palak Mata-Pita Yojana) was launched by the Gujarat government in 2009-10 to support orphaned and abandoned children. The scheme provides monthly financial assistance of ₹3,000 to relatives or caregivers of children up to 18 years of age. Its aim is to ensure children grow up in a family environment instead of institutional care. Banaskantha district has emerged as a leading district in effective implementation of the scheme. A total of 2,818 beneficiaries in Banaskantha have received support under the scheme so far. Currently, 1,727 children receive ₹51.81 lakh per month as assistance. The support helps meet education, healthcare, and daily living needs of vulnerable children.

7. The Aiyanoor Ammanoor festival is mainly associated with which tribal community?

- [A] Toda
- [B] Kota
- [C] Kurumba
- [D] Irula

Answer: Kota

The Aiyanoor Ammanoor festival of the Kota tribe was celebrated at Solur Kokkal village near Udthagamandalam in the Nilgiris district of Tamil Nadu. The Kota tribe is classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG) in Tamil Nadu. The festival is a traditional annual or periodic event reflecting the living cultural heritage of the community. Aiyanoor Amman is worshipped as the central village and guardian deity. Women play a central role by performing ritual dances in traditional white attire with distinctive borders.

8. What kind of disease is 'Ulcerative colitis' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Infectious disease
- [B] Metabolic disorder
- [C] Genetic blood disorder
- [D] Chronic inflammatory bowel disease

Answer: Chronic inflammatory bowel disease

A new study suggests ulcerative colitis may be triggered when a normally hidden protective layer of immune cells beneath the gut lining becomes thinner. Ulcerative colitis (UC) is a chronic inflammatory bowel disease (IBD) affecting the colon and rectum. It causes long-term inflammation and ulcers in the inner lining of the large intestine. Ulcerative colitis (UC) is an immune-mediated condition with cycles of flare-ups and remission.

9. National Test House (NTH) was established under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [B] Ministry of Road Transport and Highways
- [C] Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution
- [D] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer: Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution

The National Test House (NTH) will be empanelled as a recognised laboratory for the



National Highways Authority of India (NHAI). Samples related to highway construction and allied works will be sent to NTH laboratories across India for testing and inspection. National Test House (NTH) is India's largest multi-location, multidisciplinary central government testing laboratory. It conducts testing, calibration, and quality evaluation for industry, commerce, and trade as per national and international standards. It was established under the Department of Consumer Affairs, Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution. The empanelment will improve transparency, standardisation, and efficiency in quality assurance.

10. Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) was introduced by which organization?

- [A] European Union (EU)
- [B] United Nations (UN)
- [C] World Bank
- [D] African Union (AU)

Answer: European Union (EU)

The European Union has started implementing the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), affecting steel and aluminium exporters. This adds pressure on Indian metal exporters already facing a 50% duty on exports to the United States. Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) was introduced by the European Union. It is an import duty on goods produced outside Europe, based on carbon emissions during production. CBAM targets products made using carbon-intensive processes compared to EU climate standards. CBAM is in a transitional phase from 2023 to 2025 and will be fully implemented in 2026. It currently covers steel, aluminium, cement, electricity, fertilisers and selected other products.

11. What is the name of Goa's newly announced third district?

- [A] Mandovi
- [B] Zuari
- [C] Kushavati
- [D] Chandrapur

Answer: Kushavati

Goa will create its third district named Kushavati, after the ancient Kushavati River flowing through southern Goa. The river reflects Goa's ancient geography, culture, livelihood, and ecological identity from historic times like the Chalukya dynasty. The district includes Sanguem, Dharbandora, Quepem, and Canacona talukas, with headquarters at Quepem. Usgalimal petroglyphs on laterite stones along the river show early human settlement thousands of years old. The district will have a new Zilla Panchayat (District Council) to improve governance and development.

12. Amazonian stingless bees recently became the first insects in the world to be granted legal rights by which country?

- [A] Peru
- [B] Colombia
- [C] Ecuador



[D] Brazil

Answer: Peru

Amazonian stingless bees have become the first insects in the world to be granted legal rights. The decision was taken through a landmark ordinance passed by local municipalities in Peru. The law recognises their right to exist, survive, and flourish. This step highlights their critical role as pollinators in the Amazon rainforest ecosystem. It also acknowledges their importance to biodiversity, agriculture, and Indigenous communities. The move sets a global precedent for legal protection of insects and nature.

13. DESERT CYCLONE-II is a joint military exercise between India and which country?

[A] United Arab Emirates (UAE)

[B] Israel

[C] Russia

[D] France

Answer: United Arab Emirates (UAE)

Exercise DESERT CYCLONE-II concluded at Al-Hamra Training City, Abu Dhabi, from 18-30 December. It was a joint military exercise between the Indian Army and UAE Land Forces, strengthening defence partnership and regional security. Training combined classroom instruction and field exercises, focusing on urban operations and sub-conventional operations under a United Nations mandate. Troops practiced urban combat, building clearance, IED awareness, casualty evacuation, first aid, heliborne operations, air assault missions, and platoon-level assaults. The exercise enhanced interoperability, operational synergy, and standardisation of tactics for future multinational operations.

14. Hanimaadhoo International Airport, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

[A] Singapore

[B] Mauritius

[C] Indonesia

[D] Maldives

Answer: Maldives

The Indian government has asked the Airports Authority of India (AAI) to study a request from Maldives for help in managing Hanimaadhoo International Airport (HAQ). Hanimaadhoo International Airport is located on Hanimaadhoo Island, Haa Dhaalu Atoll, northern Maldives. The airport was originally developed as a domestic airport in 1986 and upgraded to international status in 2012. India supported its redevelopment and expansion with an \$800 million line of credit from EXIM Bank of India.

15. National Investigation Agency (NIA) functions under which ministry?

[A] Ministry of Home Affairs

[B] Ministry of Defence

[C] Ministry of External Affairs

[D] Ministry of Science and Technology

Answer: Ministry of Home Affairs



In 2025, the National Investigation Agency (NIA) achieved more than 92% conviction rate and key operational successes. The NIA arrested several terrorists and associates linked to the Pahalgam and Delhi attacks and filed charge sheets against seven accused, including Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) and The Resistance Front (TRF). Across 55 cases, 276 arrests were made: 67 jihadi, 74 Left-Wing Extremism (LWE), 37 Northeast insurgency, 28 pro-Khalistan, 11 gangster-related, 59 others. The National Investigation Agency (NIA) was established in 2008 after the Mumbai terror attacks to combat terrorism. The agency operates under the Union Ministry of Home Affairs, with its headquarters in New Delhi, led by the Director-General.

16. Which country has announced plans to construct a multi-layered anti-drone defence system worth about \$2.2 billion along its eastern border?

- [A] Finland
- [B] Denmark
- [C] Norway
- [D] Poland

Answer: Poland

Poland has announced a \$2.2 billion multi-layered anti-drone defence system along its eastern border due to security concerns linked to Russia-Ukraine conflict. The move follows repeated suspected Russian drone incursions, which triggered North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) air policing responses. The system will combine electronic warfare tools like drone jamming with machine guns, cannons, and missile units. It is not a physical wall but a technology-based layered defence against aerial threats. Some components will activate only during extreme or wartime conditions, addressing hybrid warfare threats like sabotage and unmanned aerial vehicles.

17. The Sirkeer Malkoha, a rare bird species recently reported in the news, is usually found in the plains of which state?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Arunachal Pradesh
- [C] Himachal Pradesh
- [D] Sikkim

Answer: Uttarakhand

The rare Sirkeer Malkoha has been recorded for the first time in Uttarkashi district of Uttarakhand. It is usually found in the plains of Uttarakhand, making this sighting significant. Sirkeer Malkoha, also called sirkeer cuckoo, is a unique type of cuckoo bird. It is found across the sub-Himalayan Indian subcontinent, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, and parts of Pakistan and Rajasthan. It lives in scrublands, thin forests, and hilly areas. The International Union for Conservation of Nature Red List classifies it as Least Concern.

18. Recently, which country became the 21st member of the Eurozone, bringing it closer to full European integration?

- [A] Romania
- [B] Croatia



[C] Serbia

[D] Bulgaria

Answer: Bulgaria

Bulgaria recently became the 21st member of the Eurozone, moving closer to full European integration. Bulgaria is located in southeastern Europe on the eastern part of the Balkan Peninsula. It shares borders with Romania, Turkey, Greece, North Macedonia, and Serbia, and has a maritime boundary with the Black Sea. The capital city of Bulgaria is Sofia.

19. The Land Stack & Glossary of Revenue Terms was launched under which programme?

[A] Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana

[B] Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme

[C] National Land Records Modernisation Project

[D] Bharat Land Information System

Answer: Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme

Minister of State for Rural Development and Communications, launched Land Stack in Chandigarh and Tamil Nadu and released the Glossary of Revenue Terms in New Delhi. These initiatives are part of the Digital India Land Record Modernisation Programme, aiming for modern, transparent, and citizen-centric land governance. Land Stack is an integrated GIS-based digital platform inspired by Singapore, the United Kingdom, and Finland. It provides single-window access to land and property information for citizens and government agencies.

20. Which city is currently aiming to become India's first slum-free city with a population of 70–80 lakh?

[A] Ahmedabad

[B] Lucknow

[C] Mumbai

[D] Surat

Answer: Surat

Surat is set to become India's first slum-free city with a population of over 70 lakh. Currently, Chandigarh is India's first slum-free city with a population of 10 lakh. In 2006, 36% of Surat's population lived in slums; it has now reduced to 5%. The government plans phased, result-oriented efforts and proper housing to achieve full slum-free status.

21. What is the name of the operation under which Delhi Police traced 1,303 missing persons in the southwest district last year?

[A] Operation Smile

[B] Operation Suraksha

[C] Operation Milap

[D] Operation Raksha

Answer: Operation Milap

Delhi Police traced 1,303 missing persons in the southwest district over the past year under Operation Milap, including 434 children and 869 adults. In December 2025 alone,



102 missing persons were found: 35 children and 67 adults. Operation Milap uses coordinated district-level efforts, inter-station cooperation, and consistent follow-up to trace missing persons. Local informers and hospital/police records played a key role, along with displaying photographs at bus stands, railway stations, auto and e-rickshaw points. The initiative emphasizes community participation, urban public safety, and focused tracing of children.

22. What are the two sub-schemes under the Export Promotion Mission?

- [A] NIRYAT UDAY and NIRYAT VIKAS
- [B] NIRYAT PROTSAHAN and NIRYAT DISHA
- [C] NIRYAT PRADHAN and NIRYAT SAMRIDDHI
- [D] NIRYAT BHARAT and NIRYAT SAMPADA

Answer: NIRYAT PROTSAHAN and NIRYAT DISHA

The Government of India launched the Export Promotion Mission with a total outlay of ₹25,060 crore for FY 2025–26 to FY 2030–31 to strengthen India's export competitiveness. The Mission focuses on Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs), first-time exporters, labour-intensive sectors, market diversification, and value-added exports. It is jointly implemented by the Department of Commerce, Ministry of MSME, and Ministry of Finance. The Mission has two sub-schemes: NIRYAT PROTSAHAN (financial support) and NIRYAT DISHA (non-financial support). Under NIRYAT PROTSAHAN, interest subvention is provided on pre- and post-shipment rupee export credit to reduce export credit costs.

23. Which ministry launched the Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS)?

- [A] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [B] Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
- [C] Ministry of Heavy Industries
- [D] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Answer: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) approved 22 proposals under the Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS). The projects have a projected investment of ₹41,863 crore and expected production of ₹2,58,152 crore. These projects cover 11 target segment products with cross-sectoral applications in mobile manufacturing, telecom, consumer electronics, strategic electronics, automotive, and IT hardware. The Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS) was launched by Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) to boost domestic production of electronic components, providing incentives and fostering a robust supply chain

24. Which state is the host of National Textiles Ministers' Conference 2026?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Manipur
- [C] Tripura
- [D] Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: Assam

The Ministry of Textiles, in collaboration with the Government of Assam, will organize the



National Textiles Ministers' Conference on 8–9 January 2026 in Guwahati, Assam. The theme is "India's Textiles: Weaving Growth, Heritage & Innovation." The conference will bring together Union and State Ministers of Textiles, senior government officials, and policymakers to discuss a coordinated national strategy. The goal aligns with developing a USD 350 billion textile industry and achieving USD 100 billion in textile exports by 2030.

25. Where was the foundation stone of the Bhoramdev Corridor Development Project laid in January 2026?

- [A] Chhattisgarh
- [B] Jharkhand
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Bihar

Answer: Chhattisgarh

In Chhattisgarh, Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai and Union Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat laid the foundation stone of the Bhoramdev Corridor Development Project at Bhoramdev Dham, Kabirdham district. The project is part of the Swadesh Darshan Scheme 2.0 of the Central Government. The corridor will be developed at an estimated cost of ₹146 crore, modeled on the Kashi Vishwanath Corridor in Varanasi. Bhoramdev Temple, known as the Khajuraho of Chhattisgarh, is famous for its ancient architecture and religious significance. The corridor will provide modern facilities for pilgrims and tourists.

26. Which city is the host of 11th India International Youth Sailing Championship 2026?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Kolkata

Answer: Chennai

The 11th India International Youth Sailing Championship 2026 takes place from 4th to 10th January at Chennai Port. The championship was officially launched in Chennai. It is India's longest-running and most consistent international youth sailing regatta. 117 sailors from 13 countries competes across five elite youth classes.

27. Which state government launched the Financial Assistance Scheme for Udasin Bhakats in January 2026?

- [A] Mizoram
- [B] Sikkim
- [C] Tripura
- [D] Assam

Answer: Assam

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma launched the Financial Assistance Scheme for Udasin Bhakats, providing ₹1,500 monthly to celibate Vaishnavite monks in Satras. Satras are monastic institutions serving as religious and cultural centres; Udasin Satras are where bhakats lead celibate lives. A total of 620 Udasin Bhakats will benefit across districts, including 474 from Majuli, 54 from Jorhat, and others from Barpeta, Dhubri,



Goalpara, Golaghat, Kamrup, Lakhimpur, Nagaon, Nalbari, Sivasagar, Sonitpur, and Udalguri. Majuli, the world's largest river island, is the core centre of Assamese Neo-Vaishnavism and Satras.

28. Global Family Day, also called World Peace Day, is observed every year on which day?

- [A] January 1
- [B] January 2
- [C] January 3
- [D] January 4

Answer: January 1

Global Family Day, also called World Peace Day, is observed every year on January 1. It promotes peace and unity worldwide and emphasizes that all people are interconnected, regardless of nationality, borders, or ethnicity. The concept began in 1997 when the UN General Assembly declared the International Decade for the Culture of Peace and Nonviolence for Children of the World. The day was first celebrated successfully in 1999 and was officially recognized by the United Nations in 2001.

29. Who received the Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Limited (IFFCO) Sahitya Samman 2025 for outstanding contribution to Hindi literature?

- [A] Maitreyi Pushpa
- [B] Vidyasagar Nautiyal
- [C] Shekhar Joshi
- [D] Ankita Sinha

Answer: Maitreyi Pushpa

Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Limited (IFFCO) conferred the IFFCO Sahitya Samman 2025 on eminent Hindi writer Maitreyi Pushpa for her outstanding contribution to Hindi literature, especially rural life and agrarian realities. The IFFCO Young Literary Award 2025 was presented to Ankita Jain for her book "Oh Re! Kisan." Maitreyi Pushpa (born 30 Nov 1944, Aligarh) has a master's in Hindi literature and is renowned for novels, short stories, plays, poetry, and women-centric writings. IFFCO Sahitya Samman, instituted in 2011, honors writers reflecting rural and agricultural life and carries a cash prize of ₹11 lakh, citation, and memento.

30. The first Vande Bharat Sleeper Train is planned to operate between which two cities?

- [A] Delhi – Mumbai
- [B] Guwahati – Howrah
- [C] Chennai – Bengaluru
- [D] Patna – Kolkata

Answer: Guwahati – Howrah

Indian Railways will introduce its first Vande Bharat Sleeper Train, upgrading overnight rail travel in India. Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw announced that testing and certification are fully completed. The inaugural route will run between Guwahati (Assam) and Howrah (West Bengal). The train will have 16 fully air-conditioned coaches with AC 3-tier, AC 2-tier, and AC First Class, carrying about 823 passengers. It features ergonomic



berths, new suspension, and modern safety systems for comfortable overnight journeys. The service will boost regional connectivity and offer Assamese and Bengali cuisine on board.

31. Tuman village, which recently received its first motorable road, is located in which district of Himachal Pradesh?

- [A] Kangra
- [B] Mandi
- [C] Kullu
- [D] Shimla

Answer: Mandi

Tuman village in Chawasi area of Mandi district, Himachal Pradesh, received its first motorable road after 78 years. The 2.7-kilometre road was constructed from Shakeld to Tuman by the Public Works Department (PWD). The village was earlier cut off from basic transport facilities for decades. A trial run of a Himachal Road Transport Corporation (HRTC) bus was successfully conducted on the new road.

32. World Braille Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] January 1
- [B] January 2
- [C] January 3
- [D] January 4

Answer: January 4

World Braille Day is observed every year on 4 January. The day marks the birth anniversary of Louis Braille, a French educator born in 1809. He invented Braille in 1824, a code using six raised dots that allows visually impaired people to read with their fingertips. Braille is used globally in many languages for reading, writing, solving math problems, scientific equations, learning music, and daily activities like shopping. In New Delhi, the National Federation of the Blind organized a function to commemorate the day and launched a campaign called More Braille More Empowerment to promote equality and dignity for visually impaired people.

33. The Grand International Exposition of Sacred Piprahwa Relics of Bhagwan Buddha was inaugurated in which city?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Jaipur

Answer: New Delhi

Recently, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Grand International Exposition of Sacred Piprahwa Relics of Bhagwan Buddha in New Delhi. The exhibition titled The Light and the Lotus displays relics repatriated after about 125 years. The Piprahwa relics were discovered in 1898 and are directly linked to Bhagwan Buddha. The Piprahwa site is associated with ancient Kapilavastu, where Buddha spent his early life. The government



stopped their international auction, considering them sacred heritage, not artifacts.

34. Mount Bur Ni Telong volcano, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Japan
- [B] China
- [C] Philippines
- [D] Indonesia

Answer: Indonesia

Recently, Indonesian authorities raised the alert level for Mount Bur Ni Telong due to increased volcanic activity and frequent earthquakes. Mount Bur Ni Telong is an active stratovolcano located in Aceh, the westernmost province of Indonesia. It is one of the most popular climbing destinations in the Aceh region. The volcano rises to about 2,624 metres above sea level. It is situated at the southern base of the large Bur Ni Geureudong volcanic complex in northern Sumatra. The volcano has a conical shape formed by layers of lava and eruptive material.

35. The ultra-rare leopard colour morph named Sandalwood Leopard was recently spotted in which state?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Karnataka

Recently, an ultra-rare leopard colour morph was documented in Vijayanagara district of Karnataka, marking the first such sighting in the state and the second in India. The leopard has been named the "Sandalwood Leopard" due to its pale reddish-pink coat resembling sandalwood. The animal is a female leopard (*Panthera pardus*), around seven years old, seen with a normally coloured cub. Such leopards are globally called "strawberry leopards" and are extremely rare. Globally, this colour morph has been recorded only five times, including one earlier sighting in Rajasthan in 2021.

36. India's first government hospital-based Artificial Intelligence (AI) clinic was inaugurated in which city?

- [A] Bengaluru, Karnataka
- [B] Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Mumbai, Maharashtra
- [D] Chennai, Tamil Nadu

Answer: Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh

Recently, India's first government hospital-based Artificial Intelligence (AI) clinic was inaugurated at the Government Institute of Medical Sciences (GIMS), Greater Noida. The AI clinic is part of the GIMS Centre for Medical Innovation to provide AI-driven healthcare directly to doctors and patients. It aims to allow healthcare startups to develop, test, and validate AI solutions in real-world clinical settings. The initiative was attended by over 100 experts, including international specialists and policymakers. The clinic will focus on



medical imaging, clinical decision support systems, and data-driven healthcare services.

37. What is the IUCN Red List status of the Eastern Imperial Eagle that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Vulnerable

Recently, an Eastern Imperial Eagle was confirmed visiting Mudumalai Tiger Reserve during the winter migratory season. The scientific name of the Eastern Imperial Eagle is *Aquila heliaca*. The species breeds in southeastern Europe and across West and Central Asia, with most populations migrating to northeastern Africa, the Middle East, and South and East Asia during winter. It is the second largest eagle in Europe, reaching about 0.92 meters in length, a wingspan of approximately 2.14 meters, and a weight of around 3.6 kilograms. According to the IUCN Red List, the Eastern Imperial Eagle is classified as Vulnerable.

38. RQ-170 "Sentinel" stealth surveillance drone is developed by which country?

- [A] China
- [B] Japan
- [C] Russia
- [D] United States

Answer: United States

A rare U.S. Air Force RQ-170 "Sentinel" stealth surveillance drone was recently spotted returning to Roosevelt Roads Naval Station in eastern Puerto Rico. The drone returned after U.S. military strikes conducted overnight against targets in Venezuela. The RQ-170 Sentinel is a high-altitude, long-endurance unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) of the United States. It was designed and manufactured by Skunk Works, a division of Lockheed Martin, for the United States Air Force (USAF). The drone is used for intelligence, surveillance, target acquisition, reconnaissance (ISTAR), and electronic warfare missions over target areas.

39. The Live Events Development Cell (LEDC) was established by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Tourism
- [B] Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- [C] Ministry of Culture
- [D] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer: Ministry of Information and Broadcasting

The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting recently established the Live Events Development Cell (LEDC) to boost India's concert economy, employment, and tourism. Live Events Development Cell (LEDC) aims to support the structured growth of India's live entertainment industry and strengthen the emerging concert economy. It will act as a single-window facilitation mechanism to streamline processes and position India as a leading global live entertainment destination by 2030. It brings together representatives



from Central and State governments, industry bodies, and major event companies for coordinated policy support and sectoral expansion.

40. Cetacean morbillivirus, that was recently seen in news, primarily affects which species?

[A] Marine mammals

[B] Amphibians

[C] Birds

[D] None of the Above

Answer: Marine mammals

Scientists recently used drones to detect a dangerous Cetacean morbillivirus (CeMV) among whales in the Arctic. Cetacean morbillivirus is a viral infection affecting marine mammals, especially cetaceans like whales, dolphins, and porpoises. CeMV has caused multiple outbreaks worldwide, particularly in the North Atlantic and the Mediterranean. Transmission occurs through respiratory routes and direct contact, with the virus shed via ocular and respiratory secretions, urine, feces, and sloughed skin. The virus affects the respiratory and neurological systems, leading to mass strandings and deaths of marine mammals.

41. The Salal Hydroelectric Project is located on which river?

[A] Ravi

[B] Jhelum

[C] Chenab

[D] Indus

Answer: Chenab

The Union Minister directed sediment removal at the Salal Power Project in Jammu and Kashmir to maximise water use amid the Indus Waters Treaty between India and Pakistan being kept in abeyance. Salal is a 690 Megawatt (MW) run-of-the-river hydroelectric project on the Chenab River in Reasi district. It is owned by National Hydroelectric Power Corporation (NHPC). It was India's first hydropower project under the Indus Waters Treaty regime in Kashmir. The dam is 130 metres high at 1627 feet above mean sea level. Jammu and Kashmir gets 12.5 percent power, while the rest goes to the Northern Grid supplying multiple northern states.

42. Taimoor is an air-launched cruise missile developed by which country?

[A] Iran

[B] Israel

[C] Iraq

[D] Pakistan

Answer: Pakistan

Pakistan Air Force recently conducted a successful flight test of the indigenously developed Taimoor Weapon System. Taimoor is an air-launched cruise missile developed by Pakistan. It is designed to hit enemy land and sea targets with high precision. It uses subsonic turbojet propulsion, enabling efficient long-range flight. The missile has a strike range of up to 600 kilometres with a conventional warhead. Its stealth features include a



box-shaped fuselage, X-type tail, and foldable wings. It flies at very low altitude to evade enemy air and missile defence systems.

43. What is the IUCN conservation status of the Bactrian camel, that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Critically Endangered

Ladakh's double-humped Bactrian camels will debut at the 77th Republic Day parade, highlighting their unique heritage. Scientifically known as *Camelus bactrianus*, they are large even-toed ungulates called Ladakh's "silent warriors". They are native to Central Asia, ranging from Afghanistan to China, mainly in the Mongolian steppes and Gobi Desert. In India, small populations survive in the high-altitude cold desert of Nubra Valley, Ladakh. They are mainly herbivores and are listed as Critically Endangered by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

44. The Indian Army has declared which year as the 'Year of Networking & Data Centricity'?

- [A] 2025
- [B] 2026
- [C] 2027
- [D] 2028

Answer: 2026

The Indian Army has declared 2026 as the 'Year of Networking & Data Centricity' to build a future-ready force. The focus is on stronger connectivity, real-time decision-making, and higher combat effectiveness. Jointness, self-reliance, and innovation are the core pillars of military power. Data centricity treats data as a key combat asset shared across platforms instantly. This enables faster targeting, efficient troop movement, and better resource use. It shifts the Army from platform-centric to network-centric warfare. The initiative supports indigenisation, defence modernisation, and seamless Army-Navy-Air Force operations.

45. Which country has commissioned an upgraded Type 052D guided missile destroyer named Loudi?

- [A] Japan
- [B] Australia
- [C] United States
- [D] China

Answer: China

The Chinese People's Liberation Army (PLA) Navy has commissioned an upgraded Type 052D guided missile destroyer named Loudi. The induction reflects China's rapid naval expansion to narrow the gap with United States naval strength. The warship adopts a new system and operational architecture. It has improved combat capabilities in air defence and sea attack roles. The destroyer also strengthens task force command and



coordination abilities. The commissioning highlights China's focus on modern, network-centric naval warfare.

46. Where was Rajasthan Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 inaugurated?

- [A] Jaipur
- [B] Jaisalmer
- [C] Udaipur
- [D] Bikaner

Answer: Jaipur

Rajasthan is hosting the Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 on 6th January in Jaipur. The event is held in collaboration with Rajasthan DigiFest and TiE Global Summit 2026, leading up to the India AI Impact Summit 2026 in February. The conference explores how Artificial Intelligence (AI) can drive governance reform, economic growth, innovation, and inclusive development. Sessions include AI for Public Service Delivery, Ethical AI, AI and Future of Employment & Skills, and Rajasthan's AI startup ecosystem.

47. The second phase of the Specialised Training Program in Cancer Care for BIMSTEC Countries was launched in which city?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] Bengaluru
- [C] Visakhapatnam
- [D] Kolkata

Answer: Visakhapatnam

The second phase of the Specialised Training Program in Cancer Care for BIMSTEC Countries was launched at Homi Bhabha Cancer Hospital and Research Centre (HBCHRC), Visakhapatnam. The initiative addresses the rising cancer burden and unequal access to quality care in the region. It aims to improve cancer care services, enhance skills, and foster regional collaboration and research. The program was announced by PM of India at the 6th BIMSTEC Summit and is implemented by Tata Memorial Centre with Ministry of External Affairs support. The program strengthens oncology capacity in the BIMSTEC region and supports equitable, high-quality cancer care.

48. Indian Coast Guard Ship (ICGS) Samudra Pratap was commissioned in which state?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Goa
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Tamil Nadu

Answer: Goa

Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh commissioned ICGS Samudra Pratap, India's first indigenously designed pollution control vessel, built by Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL), on 5th January 2026 in Goa. The ship is the largest in the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) fleet and has over 60% indigenous content, with plans to increase to 90%. It enhances the ICG's capabilities in pollution control, firefighting, maritime safety, coastal patrol, and extended surveillance. It is equipped with advanced pollution detection systems, side-sweeping



arms, skimmers, floating booms, and a pollution control lab, it can operate even in rough seas.

49. Who became the first Indian to secure a top-five global finish on debut in the IAME UAE Karting Championship?

- [A] Jehan Daruvala
- [B] Atiqa Mir
- [C] Armaan Ebrahim
- [D] Karun Singhal

Answer: Atiqa Mir

Atiqa Mir, 11-year-old Indian racing prodigy, debuted in the junior S125 category (age 12–14) after moving up from the mini category (age 8–12). She became the first Indian to secure a top-five finish globally on debut in round seven of the International Association of Karting Manufacturers (IAME) UAE Karting Championship at Yas Marina Circuit, Abu Dhabi. Atiqa finished 5th out of 35 drivers in a male-dominated grid, missing the podium by only 0.4 seconds. She is also the first female in IAME UAE Championship history to register a top-five finish.

50. Manoj Kothari, who recently passed away, was associated with which sport?

- [A] Chess
- [B] Table Tennis
- [C] Badminton
- [D] Billiards

Answer: Billiards

Former world billiards champion Manoj Kothari passed away at 67 in Tirunelveli, Tamil Nadu due to a massive cardiac arrest. Kothari won the World Billiards Championship in 1990. He was a 16-time State Champion in his career. In 2005, he received the Dhyan Chand Award, India's highest lifetime achievement award in sports. In 2025, he was honoured with a Lifetime Achievement Award by the Billiards and Snooker Federation of India.

51. Which state/UT is the host of 2nd Khelo India Beach Games 2026?

- [A] Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu
- [B] Tamil Nadu
- [C] Lakshadweep
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu

The 2nd Khelo India Beach Games officially began on 5th January 2026 at Ghoghla Beach in Diu. More than 2,100 athletes are participating across eight different sports in the event. The games are being organised by the Union Territory of Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, under the technical supervision of the Sports Authority of India and national sports federations. The event will be held from 5th to 10th January 2026. There are six medal sports: Beach Soccer, Beach Volleyball, Beach Sepak Takraw, Beach Kabaddi, Pencak Silat, and Open Water Swimming. Two events, Mallakhamb and Tug of War, are



included as non-medal events.

52. World Day of War Orphans is observed annually on which day?

- [A] January 4
- [B] January 5
- [C] January 6
- [D] January 7

Answer: January 6

World Day of War Orphans is observed annually on 6th January to raise awareness about children who have lost parents due to war or armed conflicts. The day highlights the physical, social, and psychological challenges faced by orphans growing up without parental support. It calls for protection, care, rehabilitation, and societal support systems to help war orphans rebuild their lives with dignity and security. According to UNICEF, around 140 million children worldwide are orphans: 52 million in Africa, 10 million in Latin America & the Caribbean, 7.3 million in Central Asia, and 61 million in Asia.

53. What is the name of the major joint military exercise recently conducted by Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) forces in Saudi Arabia?

- [A] Desert Shield 2026
- [B] Gulf Shield 2026
- [C] Arabian Sword 2026
- [D] Middle East Defender 2026

Answer: Gulf Shield 2026

Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) forces have launched a major joint military exercise in Saudi Arabia called "Gulf Shield 2026". The exercise aims to strengthen collective defence and improve regional military coordination among all GCC member states. It is designed to enhance combat readiness, joint operational integration, and efficiency in planning and execution in a unified operational environment. The drills include a wide range of procedures, tests, and field scenarios to assess force readiness and effectiveness of responses to potential threats.

54. The report "Economic Outlook for Southeast Asia, China and India: Enhancing Disaster Risk Financing 2025" was released by which organisation?

- [A] World Bank
- [B] United Nations Development Programme
- [C] Asian Development Bank
- [D] Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

Answer: Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

The Economic Outlook for Southeast Asia, China and India 2025 report was released by the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD). It is a regular publication analysing regional economic growth and development in Asia, with focus on Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) countries. This edition includes a thematic chapter on enhancing Disaster Risk Financing (DRF) in Emerging Asia. The report finds that India, China, and ASEAN-11 face rising frequency and intensity of natural disasters,



averaging 100 disasters annually, affecting about 80 million people.

55. National Siddha Day is observed every year on which day in India?

- [A] January 4
- [B] January 5
- [C] January 6
- [D] January 7

Answer: January 6

National Siddha Day is observed every year in India on January 6 to mark the birth anniversary of Sage Agathiyar, regarded as the father of the Siddha system of medicine. The day coincides with the Ayilyam star in the Tamil month of Margazhi. The first National Siddha Day was observed on 4 January 2018. The 9th National Siddha Day falls on 6 January 2026.

56. What is the name of the pension scheme announced by the Tamil Nadu government for state government employees and teachers?

- [A] Tamil Nadu Unified Pension Scheme
- [B] Tamil Nadu Assured Pension Scheme
- [C] Old Pension Restoration Scheme
- [D] Contributory Welfare Pension Scheme

Answer: Tamil Nadu Assured Pension Scheme

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M. K. Stalin announced the Tamil Nadu Assured Pension Scheme (TAPS) ahead of the Assembly election. Tamil Nadu Assured Pension Scheme (TAPS) guarantees a pension equal to 50% of the last-drawn monthly salary for state government employees and teachers. Employees will contribute 10% of basic salary, while the Tamil Nadu government bears the remaining cost. Pensioners will receive Dearness Allowance (DA) hikes every six months, family pension of 60%, and gratuity up to ₹25 lakh. The scheme follows a 23-year demand to restore the Old Pension Scheme (OPS) and led unions to withdraw strike plans.

57. India Energy Week (IEW) 2026 is hosted under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- [B] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- [C] Ministry of Power
- [D] Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

Answer: Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

India Energy Week (IEW) 2026 will be held in Goa from 27–30 January 2026, hosting ministers, CEOs, policymakers, financial institutions, academia, and tech providers. The event focuses on energy security, investment promotion, and scalable decarbonisation pathways amid rising global energy demand and climate commitments. IEW 2026 is hosted under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, organised by Federation of Indian Petroleum Industry (FIPI) and dmj events, providing a neutral global platform for energy cooperation.

58. Where was Third Technical Hindi Symposium “Abhyuday-3” held?



- [A] IIT Indore
- [B] IIT Kanpur
- [C] IIT Bombay
- [D] IIT Roorkee

Answer: IIT Indore

Third Technical Hindi Symposium “Abhyuday-3” was held at IIT Indore on 6 January 2026. It was jointly organised by IIT Indore, IIT Jodhpur, and CSIR–National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR–NIScPR). The event aimed to promote the use of Technical Hindi and strengthen the outreach of science and technology to wider sections of society.

59. India has inaugurated the world’s second National Environmental Standard Laboratory (NESL) in which city?

- [A] Bengaluru
- [B] New Delhi
- [C] Chennai
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: New Delhi

India inaugurated the world’s second National Environmental Standard Laboratory (NESL) and the world’s fifth National Primary Standard Facility for Solar Cell Calibration at CSIR–National Physical Laboratory (NPL), New Delhi. NESL will provide India-specific calibration and certification of air pollution monitoring systems, supporting regulatory bodies, industries, and startups, and improving policy enforcement under programmes like the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP).

60. OPEC+, a grouping of major oil-exporting countries, is headquartered in which city?

- [A] Riyadh
- [B] Paris
- [C] Geneva
- [D] Vienna

Answer: Vienna

OPEC+ has agreed in principle to maintain steady oil output despite political tensions among key members and growing geopolitical uncertainty. OPEC+ is an alliance of major oil-exporting countries formed in 2016 as an extension of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC). OPEC+ works together to adjust crude oil production and ensure stability in the global oil market. The headquarters of OPEC is located in Vienna, Austria.

61. Which organization launched the Earth Observation Satellite COSMO-SkyMed Second Generation–Flight Model 3 (CSG-FM3)?

- [A] NASA
- [B] European Space Agency
- [C] SpaceX
- [D] Arianespace

**Answer: SpaceX**

SpaceX successfully launched the COSMO-SkyMed Second Generation-Flight Model 3 (CSG-FM3) Earth Observation Satellite for the Italian Space Agency (ASI) and the Italian Ministry of Defence using a Falcon 9 rocket from Vandenberg Space Force Base, California. This mission marked the third satellite in the COSMO-SkyMed Second Generation series, the first SpaceX launch of 2026, and the first orbital rocket launch globally in 2026. CSG-FM3 is part of Italy's advanced COSMO-SkyMed Second Generation constellation, developed to strengthen global radar imaging and Earth observation capabilities.

62. The Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC) functions under the aegis of which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [B] Ministry of Textiles
- [C] Ministry of Finance
- [D] Ministry of Home Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Textiles

A Sakthivel has been appointed as the Chairman of the Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC), marking his fifth term leading the organisation. Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC) was established in 1978. It was set up under the Foreign Trade (Development and Regulation) Act, 1992. AEPC is the official body representing apparel exporters in India. It functions under the Ministry of Textiles, Government of India. Its main role is to promote and support exports of Indian garments and textiles globally.

63. Standards Help Inform and Nurture Empowered Women (SHINE) scheme is an initiative of which organization?

- [A] National Skill Development Corporation
- [B] Bureau of Indian Standards
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] Ministry of Women and Child Development

Answer: Bureau of Indian Standards

At the 79th Foundation Day of the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), the Union Minister launched the SHINE scheme in New Delhi. SHINE stands for Standards Help Inform and Nurture Empowered Women. It is a new initiative of the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS). The scheme places women at the centre of India's quality and standards journey. It provides structured training through partnerships with Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) and Self-Help Groups (SHGs). It empowers women with knowledge to ensure safety, quality, and family protection. The scheme also helps strengthen livelihoods and community awareness.

64. Wangchhu Hydro Electricity Project is located in which country?

- [A] Sri Lanka
- [B] Myanmar
- [C] Nepal
- [D] Bhutan

Answer: Bhutan



The Adani Group has started the 570 megawatt (MW) Wangchhu Hydro Electricity Project in Bhutan. It is a run-of-river hydropower project on the Wangchu River in Chukha district, Bhutan. The Wangchu River, called Raidāk River in India, is a tributary of the Brahmaputra River. The project is developed by Wangchhu Hydroelectric Power Limited (WHPL). WHPL is a joint venture of Adani Power Limited (APL) and Druk Green Power Corporation Limited (DGPC). DGPC holds 51% stake and APL holds 49%. The ₹6,000 crore project follows the Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) model.

65. Who is the author of the book "History That India Ignored" recently launched by Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant?

- [A] Vikram Seth
- [B] Prem Prakash
- [C] Arun Shourie
- [D] V. Balasubramanian

Answer: Prem Prakash

Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant launched the new edition of the book History That India Ignored by veteran journalist and Asian News International (ANI) Chairman Prem Prakash. The second edition details Veer Vinayak Damodar Savarkar's life and wrongful arrest, correcting decades of misrepresentation. It highlights the battle of Imphal by Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's Indian National Army. A chapter is dedicated to Goa's liberation from Portuguese rule, recognizing local courage and sacrifice. Prem Prakash personally witnessed Goa's liberation and the book revisits untold stories of India's freedom struggle.

66. What is 'W Ursae Majoris (W UMa)' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Binary Star
- [B] Asteroid
- [C] Exoplanet
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Binary Star

Astronomers from Aryabhata Research Institute of Observational Sciences studied the W Ursae Majoris (W UMa) star. They used data from Devasthal Fast Optical Telescope and NASA's Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite (TESS). W UMa is a low-mass contact binary and an eclipsing binary variable star. The two stars share a single outer atmosphere and orbit each other. W UMa stars show light curves with nearly equal minima and continuous brightness variation. Studying W UMa helps determine stellar masses, radii, and temperatures, aiding understanding of stellar evolution.

67. Which state has launched the International Spice Routes Heritage Network to promote cultural tourism and research?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Tamil Nadu

**Answer: Kerala**

Kerala launched the International Spice Routes Heritage Network to promote cultural tourism and research. The initiative leverages Kerala's historic role in maritime spice trade to drive economic and tourism growth. The platform supports collaborative research, heritage conservation, archaeology, documentation, and museum development. The project aims to reconnect ancient trade routes, revive historical memories, and foster cross-border partnerships. Muziris and Kochi's historical ports are highlighted as centres of global exchange of spices, ideas, and culture.

68. Which state has the highest number of dedicated social media monitoring cells as of 2024?

[A] West Bengal

[B] Bihar

[C] Assam

[D] Maharashtra

Answer: Bihar

Over the past five years, police across India have expanded social media monitoring to track evolving crime trends. Dedicated social media monitoring cells increased from 262 in 28 States and 8 Union Territories in 2020 to 365 by 2024. Bihar (52), Maharashtra (50), Punjab (48), West Bengal (38), and Assam (37) have the highest number of cells. Cyber Crime police stations rose from 376 in 2020 to 624 in 2024. Drones in police forces increased to 1,147 in 2024 from 1,010 in 2023. India has 5,92,839 vacant police posts out of a sanctioned strength of 27,55,274.

69. Sagar Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

[A] Tamil Nadu

[B] Kerala

[C] West Bengal

[D] Maharashtra

Answer: West Bengal

West Bengal Chief Minister laid the foundation stone of a 5-km bridge over the Muriganga River to connect Sagar Island with the mainland. Sagar Island, also called Gangasagar or Sagardwip, is in the Ganges delta, West Bengal, about 100 km south of Kolkata. It is part of South 24 Parganas district and comprises 43 villages. The island lies at the mouth of the Hooghly River, separated from the mainland to the east. Sagar Island is a sacred Hindu pilgrimage site where thousands visit during the Gangasagar Fair in mid-January.

70. Which organization developed the India's first home-made instrument named "Dust EXperiment (DEX)" to detect interplanetary dust particles?

[A] Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA)

[B] Physical Research Laboratory (PRL), Ahmedabad

[C] Indian Space Science Organization (ISSO)

[D] Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC)

Answer: Physical Research Laboratory (PRL), Ahmedabad

ISRO's maiden home-made dust detector, Dust EXperiment (DEX), detects interplanetary



dust particles (IDPs) striking Earth roughly every 1,000 seconds. DEX is the first Indian-made instrument designed to study high-speed interplanetary dust particles (IDPs). Interplanetary Dust Particles are microscopic fragments originating from comets and asteroids. The instrument was flown on the POEM (PSLV Orbital Experimental Module) of PSLV-C58. Dust EXperiment (DEX) was developed by the Physical Research Laboratory (PRL), Ahmedabad.

71. Which organization has declared 2026 as the 'International Year for Rangelands and Pastoralists'?

- [A] African Union
- [B] European Union
- [C] United Nations
- [D] World Bank

Answer: United Nations

The United Nations has declared 2026 as the 'International Year for Rangelands and Pastoralists'. Rangelands cover around half of the Earth's land surface, including grasslands, savannas, shrublands, deserts, wetlands, and mountain areas. Key examples of rangelands are the steppes of Central Asia, African savanna, Alps and Pyrenees in Europe, Andes in South America, and the Great Plains of the United States. Rangelands preserve unique flora and fauna and provide essential ecosystem services such as carbon storage and water regulation. Pastoralists raise animals, contribute to food security, and carry diverse cultural heritage and indigenous knowledge.

72. Anahat Singh won which medal in the women's U-19 final at the British Junior Open Squash Championships?

- [A] Gold medal
- [B] Silver medal
- [C] Bronze medal
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Silver medal

Anahat Singh, India's top-seeded squash player, won the silver medal in the women's U-19 final at the British Junior Open Squash Championships. The final was held at the University of Birmingham, England. She lost to France's Lauren Baltayan with scores 9-11, 11-7, 3-11, 9-11. In the semifinals, Anahat had defeated Egypt's Malika El Karaksy to reach the final.

73. What is the theme of India International Conference on Democracy and Election Management (IICDEM 2026)?

- [A] Democracy for Inclusive Growth and Development
- [B] Democracy for an Inclusive, Peaceful, Resilient and Sustainable World
- [C] Global Elections: Challenges and Innovations
- [D] Strengthening Democratic Institutions Worldwide

Answer: Democracy for an Inclusive, Peaceful, Resilient and Sustainable World

The India International Conference on Democracy and Election Management (IICDEM 2026) unveiled its official logo ahead of the three-day conference at Bharat Mandapam,



New Delhi, from January 21, 2026. The conference is organised by the India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management (IIIDEM) under the Election Commission of India (ECI). The theme of the conference is "Democracy for an inclusive, peaceful, resilient and sustainable world." The logo features stylised human forms resembling protective hands, symbolising citizens as the foundation of democracy and the responsibility to safeguard democratic values.

74. The Sports Authority of India (SAI) is the apex national sports body established by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Education
- [B] Ministry of Home Affairs
- [C] Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
- [D] Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment

Answer: Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

The Sports Authority of India (SAI) launched a four-day Sports Sciences Workshop for combat sports coaches at its Sports Science Division in New Delhi to improve scientific coaching methods. The Sports Authority of India (SAI) is the apex national sports body of India established by Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Government of India. It was established in 1984 to continue the legacy of the Ninth Asian Games held in New Delhi in 1982. SAI is a registered society fully funded by the Government of India. Its main objectives are promoting sports and achieving excellence at national and international levels.

75. HPCL commissioned the world's first and largest Liquid Conversion–Maximum (LC-Max) Residue Upgradation Facility (RUF) at which place?

- [A] Mumbai, Maharashtra
- [B] Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh
- [C] Paradip, Odisha
- [D] Kochi, Kerala

Answer: Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh

On January 5, 2026, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL) under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG) commissioned the world's first and largest Liquid Conversion–Maximum (LC-Max) Residue Upgradation Facility (RUF) at Visakhapatnam Refinery in Andhra Pradesh. It was developed under the Visakh Refinery Modernization Project (VRMP) with an investment of ₹31,407 crore. Refinery capacity increased from 8.33 to 15 Million Metric Tonnes Per Annum (MMTPA). The residue hydrocracking unit of 3.55 Million Tonnes Per Annum (MTPA) converts about 93% low-value residue into high-value fuels.

76. Which telescope of NASA recently discovered a new astronomical object named Cloud-9?

- [A] Spitzer Space Telescope
- [B] Roman Space Telescope
- [C] Hubble Space Telescope
- [D] James Webb Space Telescope

**Answer: Hubble Space Telescope**

NASA's Hubble Space Telescope discovered a new astronomical object named Cloud-9. Cloud-9 is a starless, gas-rich, dark-matter-dominated cloud, classified as a Reionization-Limited H I Cloud (RELHIC). It is located 14 million light-years from Earth, near the spiral galaxy Messier 94 (M94). The cloud is made of neutral hydrogen (H I) spanning about 4,900 light-years, with a mass approx 1 million times the Sun. Cloud-9's dark matter mass is estimated at 5 billion solar masses. It is a relic of early galaxy formation, a "failed galaxy" that did not form stars.

77. Earth's Rotation Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] January 7
- [B] January 8
- [C] January 9
- [D] January 10

Answer: January 8

Earth's Rotation Day is observed every year on 8 January to highlight Earth's continuous rotation on its axis. It commemorates the 1851 Foucault Pendulum experiment conducted by French physicist Léon Foucault. The experiment gave the first clear experimental proof that Earth rotates on its axis. Earth's rotation causes the day-night cycle and influences climate and wind patterns. The day promotes awareness of basic Earth science and astronomy.

78. Madhav Gadgil, who recently passed away, was associated with which field?

- [A] Environment and Ecology
- [B] Literature
- [C] Sports
- [D] Politics

Answer: Environment and Ecology

Renowned Indian ecologist Madhav Dhananjaya Gadgil passed away on 7 January 2026 in Pune at the age of 82. He was the founder of the Centre for Ecological Sciences at the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru. He chaired the Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP) in 2010, known as the Gadgil Commission. He played a key role in establishing India's first biosphere reserve, the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve (1986). He significantly contributed to the Biological Diversity Act, 2002 and People's Biodiversity Registers. He received major honours including Padma Shri, Padma Bhushan, and United Nations Champions of the Earth Award (2024).

79. Swadesh Darshan 2.0, PRASHAD, and SASCI are the initiatives of which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Tourism
- [B] Ministry of Culture
- [C] Ministry of Finance
- [D] Ministry of External Affairs

Answer: Ministry of Tourism

The Ministry of Tourism focused on infrastructure, sustainable tourism, global promotion,



and skill development through initiatives like Swadesh Darshan 2.0, PRASHAD, and SASCI. In 2024, India recorded 20.57 million International Tourist Arrivals (ITAs), ₹2,93,033 crore Foreign Exchange Earnings (FEEs) and 2948.19 million Domestic Tourist Visits (DTV). Swadesh Darshan Scheme sanctioned 76 projects worth ₹5290.33 crore, with 75 completed. Swadesh Darshan 2.0 (SD 2.0) focuses on sustainable tourism with 53 projects worth ₹2208.27 crore. PRASHAD (Pilgrimage Rejuvenation and Spiritual Augmentation Drive) Scheme approved 54 pilgrimage projects worth ₹1726.74 crore, with 31 completed. Special Assistance to States for Capital Investment (SASCI) –Iconic Tourist Centres sanctioned 40 projects in 23 States worth ₹3295.76 crore.

80. The PANKHUDI portal was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Finance
- [B] Ministry of Women and Child Development
- [C] Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- [D] Ministry of Science and Technology

Answer: Ministry of Women and Child Development

The Ministry of Women and Child Development launched the PANKHUDI Portal on 8 January 2026. It is an integrated Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) and partnership facilitation digital platform. PANKHUDI brings together government, citizens, Non-Resident Indians (NRIs), Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs), and corporates. It supports sectors like nutrition, health, Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE), child protection, and women empowerment. It strengthens Mission Saksham Anganwadi & Poshan 2.0, Mission Vatsalya, and Mission Shakti.

81. According to the United Nations (UN) report, what is India's projected GDP growth rate in 2026?

- [A] 5.5%
- [B] 6.6%
- [C] 7.4%
- [D] 8.2%

Answer: 6.6%

A United Nations (UN) report projects India's GDP growth at 6.6% in 2026, while global growth is expected to slow to 2.7% due to geopolitical risks and policy uncertainty. The report notes that strong demand in major markets may partially offset the impact of US tariff hikes on India. The UN lowered India's growth estimate from 7.4% but it aligns with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) forecast, identifying India as the only major economy expected to grow above 6% in 2025–26. Global growth faces risks of a prolonged slowdown, insufficient for broad-based development, leaving many countries and communities behind.

82. Indian middle-distance runner Jinson Johnson, who recently announced his retirement, belongs to which state?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Karnataka



[C] Kerala

[D] Maharashtra

Answer: Kerala

National record-holder and Asian Games gold-winning Indian middle-distance runner Jinson Johnson announced his retirement at age 34. He is from Kerala and specializes in 800 metres and 1500 metres events. His career highlight was winning the 1500 metres gold at the 2018 Jakarta Asian Games with a time of 3:44.72 minutes. He also won a silver medal in the 800 metres at the same Asian Games. In 2018, Johnson broke Sriram Singh's 42-year-old men's 800 metres national record at the National Inter-State Championship in Guwahati with 1:45.65 minutes.

83. The Weimar Triangle is a political grouping of which three countries?

[A] France, Germany, Poland

[B] Italy, Spain, France

[C] Russia, India, China

[D] India, Nepal, Bhutan

Answer: France, Germany, Poland

India's External Affairs Minister joined India's first engagement with the Weimar Triangle alongside France, Poland, and Germany. The Weimar Triangle is a regional political grouping of France, Germany, and Poland. It was formed on 29 August 1991 through a joint declaration at Weimar in Germany. Its aim was to involve France in German-Polish reconciliation using Franco-German experience. It seeks to strengthen political dialogue and cooperation among the three countries.

84. The Directorate General of Mines Safety (DGMS) functions under which ministry?

[A] Ministry of Coal

[B] Ministry of Home Affairs

[C] Ministry of Labour and Employment

[D] Ministry of Heavy Industries

Answer: Ministry of Labour and Employment

The Directorate General of Mines Safety (DGMS) celebrated its 125th Foundation Day at Dhanbad, Jharkhand. It is a regulatory agency under the Ministry of Labour and Employment, Government of India. It ensures occupational safety, health, and welfare of workers employed in mines. It is headed by the Director-General of Mines Safety and headquartered at Dhanbad.

85. What is the name of the initiative launched by Senapati Forest Division to rejuvenate the Barak River watershed in Manipur?

[A] Rapid Rural Appraisal

[B] Participatory Rural Appraisal

[C] Integrated Watershed Survey

[D] Community Forest Mapping

Answer: Participatory Rural Appraisal

The Senapati Forest Division launched Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) exercises to



restore the Barak River watershed and support local livelihoods. The exercise was conducted at Saranamai village in Senapati district, Manipur, under the Barak catchment area. It involved community mapping of natural resources, land use, wealth status, matrix ranking, timelines, and Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats (SWOT) analysis. The exercise will provide baseline data for an action plan under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority (CAMPA) scheme of the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC).

86. Vera C. Rubin Observatory, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Russia
- [B] Germany
- [C] China
- [D] Chile

Answer: Chile

Scientists used first images from the Vera C. Rubin Observatory to discover the fastest-spinning asteroid of its size, named 2025 MN45. The Vera C. Rubin Observatory is located on Cerro Pachón in the Chilean Andes at 8,684 feet altitude. It is named after astronomer Vera C. Rubin, who provided early evidence for dark matter. It is jointly funded by the United States National Science Foundation (NSF) and the United States Department of Energy (DoE). Its goals include studying dark matter and dark energy, mapping the Milky Way, tracking asteroids and comets, and observing changing cosmic objects.

87. Which state's police secured first position in the ICJS (Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System) 2.0 national ranking?

- [A] Haryana
- [B] Uttarakhand
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Jharkhand

Answer: Uttarakhand

Sunil Kumar Meena, IG of Police (Crime & Law & Order) and Chief Spokesperson, highlighted two major achievements of Uttarakhand Police. Uttarakhand Police secured first position in the ICJS (Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System) 2.0 national ranking with a score of 93.46. ICJS 2.0 integrates police, courts, prosecution, prisons, forensics, and fingerprint databases on a single digital platform. Uttarakhand completed most ICJS modules ahead of schedule, ensuring seamless case diaries, charge sheets, digital evidence, and judicial processes.

88. Which state government has launched India's first dedicated Deep Tech Policy?

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Andhra Pradesh
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Tamil Nadu

The Tamil Nadu government has launched India's first dedicated Deep Tech Policy called



the Tamil Nadu Deep Tech Startup Policy 2025-2026 (TNDTSP). Chief Minister M.K. Stalin unveiled the policy at UImagineTN 2026 to strengthen innovation-led growth and position Tamil Nadu as a premier deep tech hub. The policy aims to foster advanced innovation, drive industrial growth, empower Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs), and accelerate Tamil Nadu's journey towards a \$1 trillion economy. The iTNT Hub will act as the nodal implementing agency, coordinating initiatives, managing funds, and serving as a single point of contact for stakeholders.

89. Which organization released the World Economic Situation and Prospects 2026 report?

- [A] Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)
- [B] World Bank
- [C] United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UNDESA)
- [D] International Monetary Fund (IMF)

Answer: United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UNDESA)

The United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UNDESA) released the World Economic Situation and Prospects 2026 report. India's GDP growth for 2025-26 is projected at 7.2%, slightly below the 7.4% forecast by the Indian government. India is now the fourth largest economy in the world. Growth is expected to be supported by resilient consumption, strong public investment, recent tax reforms, and monetary easing, which largely offset the impact of higher U.S. tariffs. On a fiscal year basis, India's GDP is projected to grow 6.6% in 2026-27 and 6.8% in 2027-28.

90. World Hindi Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] January 8
- [B] January 9
- [C] January 10
- [D] January 11

Answer: January 10

World Hindi Day is observed on January 10 every year. The date marks the anniversary of the first World Hindi Conference, held in Nagpur in 1975. The day is officially observed by the Government of India, primarily through Indian embassies and missions abroad. The day highlights how Hindi connects people across borders, especially Indian communities living abroad.

91. Which city officially declared a waterborne disease outbreak as an epidemic after several deaths in the Bhagirathpura area?

- [A] Bhopal
- [B] Indore
- [C] Satna
- [D] Gwalior

Answer: Indore

Indore declared a waterborne disease outbreak as an epidemic after reported fatalities in Bhagirathpura, marking a serious public health emergency. The declaration prompted immediate emergency containment and response measures. Special teams from central



and state agencies were deployed to identify the source of contamination. Experts from the National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC) and Indian Council of Medical Research - National Institute for Research in Bacterial Infections (ICMR-NIRBI) assisted in the investigation. Authorities are examining whether pipeline leaks caused single or multiple contamination points, emphasizing the need for infrastructure safety.

92. Who became the longest-serving Chief Minister of Karnataka by surpassing D. Devaraj Urs?

- [A] S. Nijalingappa
- [B] Siddaramaiah
- [C] D.K. Shivakumar
- [D] R. Gundu Rao

Answer: Siddaramaiah

Seventy-eight-year-old Congress leader Siddaramaiah became the longest-serving Chief Minister of Karnataka on January 7, 2026, surpassing the record of his role model and social justice icon D. Devaraj Urs. D. Devaraj Urs served as Chief Minister for seven years and 239 days across two terms (1972–1977 and 1978–1980), while Siddaramaiah has served since May 2023, after completing a full earlier term from 2013 to 2018. Urs is remembered for land reforms, while Siddaramaiah earned the image of “champion of the poor” through Bhagya schemes and later five guarantee schemes.

93. *Leptobrachium somani* and *Leptobrachium mechuka*, recently seen in the news, belongs to which species?

- [A] Spider
- [B] Ant
- [C] Frog
- [D] Snake

Answer: Frog

Scientists led by “Frogman of India” S. D. Biju discovered two new frog species from remote mountain regions of Arunachal Pradesh. Soman’s Slender Arm Frog, scientifically named *Leptobrachium somani*, was discovered at Tiwarigaon and named in honour of environmental journalist E. Somanath. This small frog is about 55 millimetres long, has a greyish-brown body with light-grey markings, and silver-grey to light-blue eyes. It lives in evergreen forests, with males calling near slow or fast-flowing streams. Mechuka Slender Arm Frog, known as *Leptobrachium mechuka*, is named after Mechuka town where it was first found.

94. Which institution launched “Creator’s Corner platform” to empower digital creators across India?

- [A] Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- [B] Press Information Bureau
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] Prasar Bharati

Answer: Prasar Bharati

Prasar Bharati recently launched “Creator’s Corner” on DD News to empower digital



creators across India. It is a dedicated platform to showcase content created by independent digital creators on a national television network. The initiative aims to promote the digital economy by encouraging quality content creation and wider outreach through collaboration. Content will cover news and current affairs, culture, travel, cuisine, art, literature, music, health, education, science and technology, environment, and entertainment. The programme will be telecast at 7:00 PM from Monday to Friday on DD News.

95. Grey slender loris, that was recently recently seen in news, is mainly found in which region of India?

- [A] Northeastern region
- [B] Southern India
- [C] Chotanagpur plateau
- [D] Himalayas

Answer: Southern India

Kerala and Tamil Nadu have started restoring habitats and strengthening monitoring of the grey slender loris. The grey slender loris, scientifically called *Loris lydekkerianus*, is a primate belonging to the family Loridae and is a prosimian, an ancient group of primates. It is found in southern India, mainly Karnataka, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu, and also in Sri Lanka. It lives in rainforests, dry forests, scrublands, bamboo areas, swamps, and montane cloud forests. It is listed as Near Threatened by the International Union for Conservation of Nature.

96. The fifth edition of the Tri-Services Veterans Day parade was hosted by which city?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] New Delhi
- [C] Kolkata
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: Mumbai

Mumbai hosted the fifth Tri-Services Veterans Day parade at Marine Drive ahead of Veterans Day. The event was held from 8 AM to 11 AM with participation of over 500 veterans, including gallantry award winners and octogenarians. Mumbai is the only city in India to host a city-level Veterans Day parade. The event was organised by the Navy Foundation Mumbai Chapter with support from Headquarters Western Naval Command. Tri-Services Veterans Day marks the retirement of Field Marshal K. M. Cariappa, first Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Army, on 14 January 1953.

97. Justice Revati Mohite Dere has become the first woman chief justice of which state?

- [A] Sikkim
- [B] Meghalaya
- [C] Assam
- [D] Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: Meghalaya

Justice Revati Mohite Dere was sworn in as Meghalaya's first woman Chief Justice at



Durbar Hall, Lok Bhavan, Shillong. The oath was administered by Governor Chandrashekhar H Vijayashankar. She succeeded Chief Justice Soumen Sen, who was transferred to Kerala High Court. Prior to this, Justice Dere served as a judge at the Bombay High Court. Her appointment was recommended by the Supreme Court collegium on 18 December 2025.

98. Where was Uttar Pradesh Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 held?

- [A] Gorakhpur
- [B] Meerut
- [C] Varanasi
- [D] Lucknow

Answer: Lucknow

IndiaAI, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and the Government of Uttar Pradesh hosted the Uttar Pradesh Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 in Lucknow on 12–13 January 2026. The Conference aims to showcase the use of artificial intelligence (AI) in governance and public service delivery and to align state-level initiatives with the IndiaAI Mission. It serves as a precursor to the IndiaAI Impact Summit 2026, which will be held in New Delhi from 16–20 February 2026. This event is part of a national series of eight Regional AI Impact Conferences across India.

99. Dal Lake, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state/UT?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Jammu and Kashmir
- [C] Himachal Pradesh
- [D] Uttarakhand

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

Parts of Dal Lake in Srinagar recently froze as the city recorded its coldest winter night, with temperatures well below freezing across the Kashmir Valley. Dal Lake is a mid-altitude urban freshwater lake located in Srinagar, Jammu and Kashmir. It is surrounded by the Pir Panjal mountains. The lake is vital for tourism and recreation and is called the “Jewel in the crown of Kashmir” or “Srinagar’s Jewel.”

100. Indian Giant Squirrel, that was recently seen in news, is the state animal of which state?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Maharashtra

During the All India Tiger Estimation 2026 survey, the Indian giant squirrel was sighted in the Atwan region of the Pune forest division. The Indian Giant Squirrel is also known as the Malabar Giant Squirrel and is a large rodent species native to India. It belongs to the category of tree squirrels and is adapted to living in forest canopies. It is among the largest squirrel species found in the world. The species is mainly distributed across the Western Ghats, Eastern Ghats, and the Satpura Range. It is the state animal of



Maharashtra and is locally known as Shekru.

101. Who chaired the 9th Apex-Level Meeting of the Narco-Coordination Centre (NCORD) held in New Delhi?

- [A] Union Home Minister
- [B] Prime Minister
- [C] Defence Minister
- [D] External Affairs Minister

Answer: Union Home Minister

Recently, the Union Home Minister chaired the 9th Apex-Level Meeting of the Narco-Coordination Centre (NCORD) at Vigyan Bhawan in New Delhi. The Narco-Coordination Centre (NCORD) was established in 2016 to improve coordination between States and the Ministry of Home Affairs. It was further strengthened in 2019 through a four-tier coordination system. The main purpose of NCORD is to address the drug menace in a holistic and coordinated manner. It enhances cooperation, communication, and intelligence sharing among law enforcement and drug control agencies.

102. Which state government has renamed Aralam Wildlife Sanctuary as Aralam Butterfly Sanctuary?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Tamil Nadu
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Kerala

The Kerala government has renamed Aralam Wildlife Sanctuary as Aralam Butterfly Sanctuary, making it the first butterfly sanctuary in the state. The sanctuary is located in Kerala and shares boundaries with Brahmagiri Wildlife Sanctuary in Karnataka, Kottiyoor Wildlife Sanctuary, and the North Wayanad forest division. It consists mainly of evergreen and semi-evergreen forest vegetation. The Cheenkanni River, originating from the Brahmagiri ranges, flows through the dense forests of the sanctuary.

103. What is the name of the pan-Army digital platform launched by the Indian Army in January 2026 to modernise logistics management?

- [A] LogiNet
- [B] Depot Integration Management Edition (DIME)
- [C] Army Logistics Cloud
- [D] e-Supply Chain

Answer: Depot Integration Management Edition (DIME)

The Indian Army has launched Depot Integration Management Edition, which is a pan-Army digital logistics platform. It provides near real-time visibility of logistic items from units up to Army Headquarters. It is developed jointly by the Indian Army and Bhaskaracharya National Institute for Space Applications and Geo-informatics. The platform standardises digital workflows across all Army depots and units. It equips commanders with integrated dashboards, exception alerts, and predictive stock analytics.



It will reduce paperwork by about 70 percent and shorten the logistics cycle by one-third.

104. Which Indian Army officer received the UN Secretary-General's Award 2025 for her contribution to gender-inclusive peacekeeping?

- [A] Major Anjali Singh
- [B] Major Suman Sharma
- [C] Major Swathi Shantha Kumar
- [D] Major Radhika Menon

Answer: Major Swathi Shantha Kumar

Major Swathi Shantha Kumar, an Indian Army officer from Bengaluru, received the UN Secretary-General's Award 2025 for gender-inclusive peacekeeping. She is currently serving with the United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS). Her project, "Equal Partners, Lasting Peace," strengthens UNMISS's gender-inclusive approach. The award recognises initiatives promoting gender parity and gender-responsive peacekeeping. Her project was selected from UN-wide nominations and won the Gender Category with the highest votes globally.

105. What is the primary objective of ISRO's Aditya-L1 mission?

- [A] Study the Moon's surface
- [B] Study the Sun and its effects on space weather
- [C] Explore Mars' atmosphere
- [D] Monitor Earth's oceans

Answer: Study the Sun and its effects on space weather

ISRO's Aditya-L1 mission decoded the impact of a powerful solar storm on Earth's magnetic shield. Aditya-L1, India's first space-based solar mission, was launched by PSLV-C57 in 2023 and is in a halo orbit around Lagrange Point 1 (L1). The storm was caused by a massive eruption of solar plasma from the Sun. The most severe effects occurred in turbulent regions that strongly compressed Earth's magnetic field. Some geostationary satellites were exposed to harsh space conditions. The study highlights the importance of understanding space weather, caused by transient solar activity, affecting satellites, communications, and technology.

106. AyulSAT is a 25-kg dedicated tanker and target satellite developed by which Indian startup?

- [A] Skyroot Aerospace
- [B] Bellatrix Aerospace
- [C] AgniSpace Technologies
- [D] OrbitAid Aerospace

Answer: OrbitAid Aerospace

India will demonstrate in-orbit satellite refuelling for the first time with OrbitAid's AyulSAT launched on ISRO's PSLV-C62. AyulSAT is a 25-kg dedicated tanker and target satellite developed by Chennai-based OrbitAid Aerospace, founded by Sakthikumar Ramachandran. It is designed to demonstrate fuel, power, and data transfer in orbit using a standardized docking and refuelling interface. The satellite will first perform internal refuelling to study fluid behaviour in microgravity. It uses OrbitAid's Standard Interface for



Docking and Refuelling Port (SIDRP) for future spacecraft-to-spacecraft refuelling.

107. Which country is the host of 28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth (CSPOC)?

- [A] Papua New Guinea
- [B] India
- [C] Australia
- [D] Canada

Answer: India

India is hosting the 28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth (CSPOC) in New Delhi from 14–16 January 2026. The three-day conference brings together Speakers and Presiding Officers from over 60 Commonwealth countries and semi-autonomous Parliaments. The aim is to promote knowledge and understanding of parliamentary democracy and develop parliamentary institutions. Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla is the Chairperson of the 28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth (CSPOC).

108. What is the primary payload of ISRO's PSLV-C62 mission?

- [A] EOS-N1 (Anvesha)
- [B] Cartosat-3
- [C] GSAT-20
- [D] RISAT-2BR2

Answer: EOS-N1 (Anvesha)

Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)'s Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle-C62 (PSLV-C62) mission faced an anomaly at the end of the third stage (PS3), and a detailed technical investigation has been started. PSLV-C62 is a multi-payload mission carrying one primary satellite and 18 secondary payloads. It is ISRO's first space launch of the year 2026, scheduled from Sriharikota spaceport. The primary payload is Earth Observation Satellite-N1 (EOS-N1), codenamed Anvesha. EOS-N1 is a hyperspectral imaging satellite developed mainly for the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).

109. The Central Ground Water Board (CGWB) is a multidisciplinary scientific organization under which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- [B] Ministry of Earth Sciences
- [C] Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare
- [D] Ministry of Jal Shakti

Answer: Ministry of Jal Shakti

The Central Ground Water Board (CGWB) stated in its Annual Ground Water Quality Report-2025 that Andhra Pradesh faces widespread groundwater contamination as per Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS). Central Ground Water Board (CGWB) is a multidisciplinary scientific organization under the Department of Water Resources, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation, Ministry of Jal Shakti. It is the national apex agency responsible for scientific management, exploration, monitoring, assessment,



augmentation, and regulation of groundwater in India.

110. Phayre's Leaf Monkey, that was recently seen in news, is mainly found in which region of India?

- [A] Western Ghats
- [B] North-Eastern India
- [C] Central India
- [D] Eastern Ghats

Answer: North-Eastern India

Rapid habitat destruction has forced the arboreal Phayre's leaf monkey to change its natural behaviour and habits. Phayre's leaf monkey (*Trachypithecus phayrei*) is an Old World monkey that is diurnal and tree-dwelling. It lives in tropical, deciduous, and evergreen forests, and is also found in bamboo clusters and rubber plantations. It is distributed in North-East India, mainly Tripura, Assam, and Mizoram, along with eastern Bangladesh and western Myanmar. Its conservation status is Endangered on the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List.

111. Which country has been designated as the Guest of Honour at New Delhi World Book Fair (NDWBF) 2026?

- [A] Spain
- [B] France
- [C] Qatar
- [D] United Kingdom

Answer: Qatar

The New Delhi World Book Fair (NDWBF) 2026, the world's largest book fair, has begun at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi and will continue until January 18, 2026. Entry is free for the first time to promote a strong reading culture across India. It is the 53rd edition, organised by the National Book Trust (NBT) under the Ministry of Education, Government of India. The fair features participation from over 35 countries, more than 1,000 publishers, 3,000+ stalls, 600 events, and over 1,000 speakers. The theme is "Indian Military History: Valour & Wisdom @ 75", with Qatar as Guest of Honour and Spain as Focus Country.

112. Bhadrakali inscription, that was recently seen in news, recorded the information about which temple?

- [A] Somnath Temple, Gujarat
- [B] Tirumala Venkateswara Temple, Andhra Pradesh
- [C] Kashi Vishwanath Temple, Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Jagannath Temple, Odisha

Answer: Somnath Temple, Gujarat

The Bhadrakali inscription is a major 12th-century record confirming the history, development, and royal patronage of the Somnath Temple. It is located at Prabhas Patan, Gujarat, on the wall of the Bhadrakali Temple. It was carved in 1169 Common Era (CE), corresponding to Valabhi Samvat 850 and Vikram Samvat 1255, and is protected by the



State Department of Archaeology. It records Somnath Temple's construction across four yugas: gold in Satya Yuga by Chandra (Soma), silver in Treta Yuga by Ravana, wood in Dvapara Yuga by Shri Krishna, and stone in Kali Yuga by King Bhimdev Solanki.

113. Man-Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) weapon system is developed by which organization?

- [A] Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO)
- [B] Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- [C] Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)
- [D] Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

Answer: Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and the Indian Army recently conducted successful trials of the indigenous Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) Weapon System. It is fully designed and developed in India by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO). The system includes the missile, launcher, target acquisition system, and fire control unit. It is a third-generation "fire and forget" missile with advanced autonomy after launch. It uses an Imaging Infrared (IIR) homing seeker for accurate day-and-night operations

114. Bannerghatta National Park (BNP) is located in which state?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Karnataka

The Central Empowered Committee recommended restoring the Ecologically Sensitive Zone (ESZ) of Bannerghatta National Park (BNP) to its original 2016 extent. Bannerghatta National Park is located in the Anekal range hills near Bengaluru, Karnataka. India's first butterfly enclosure was opened here in 2006. The Suvarnamukhi stream flows through the park and is the main water source for wildlife. It is a key habitat for endangered Asian elephants, tigers, leopards, Indian gaur, deer species, sloth bear, pangolin, and slender loris.

115. The National Environmental Standard Laboratory (NESL) has been established by which organisation?

- [A] Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
- [B] Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – National Physical Laboratory (CSIR–NPL)
- [C] Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
- [D] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – National Physical Laboratory (CSIR–NPL)

The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research–National Physical Laboratory (CSIR–NPL) established the National Environmental Standard Laboratory (NESL). It is located at the CSIR–National Physical Laboratory in New Delhi. It was set up to test and recalibrate air



pollution monitoring instruments and environmental sensors under Indian conditions. It ensures reliable and credible data for the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP). It allows manufacturers, industries, and municipal bodies to validate instrument performance within India. It supports industrial emission audits, smart city monitoring networks, and provides reference gases and standard protocols.

116. Bargi Dam, that was recently seen in news, is constructed on which river?

- [A] Godavari
- [B] Krishna
- [C] Kaveri
- [D] Narmada

Answer: Narmada

The National Dam Safety Authority issued a show-cause notice to the Narmada Valley Development Authority over safety issues at Bargi Dam. Bargi Dam is a major multipurpose project used for irrigation, drinking water supply, and hydroelectric power generation. It is built on the Narmada River in Madhya Pradesh. Among about 30 major dam projects on the Narmada River, it is one of the earliest completed dams. The dam was developed under the Narmada Valley Development Project to support regional water and energy needs.

117. Where was the 3rd Indian Lighthouse Festival 3.0 held?

- [A] Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- [B] Bengaluru, Karnataka
- [C] Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh
- [D] Chennai, Tamil Nadu

Answer: Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh

The 3rd Indian Lighthouse Festival 3.0 was held from 9–10 January 2026 at MGM Park, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh. It was organized by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW) and the Director General of Lighthouses and Lightships (DGLL). A Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was exchanged between Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA) and DGLL to develop a Lighthouse Museum in Visakhapatnam.

118. Which state has taken the lead in implementing the Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry (APAAR) system as of January 2026?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Chhattisgarh

Answer: Chhattisgarh

Chhattisgarh leads among larger states in implementing the Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry (APAAR) system. As of 7 January 2026, 50,60,941 APAAR IDs were generated out of 57,10,207 students in 57,045 schools, achieving 88.63% coverage. APAAR IDs provide a permanent, secure digital academic identity for students, storing achievements, certificates, and credits. Bemetara district has the highest coverage at



96.40%, followed by Rajnandgaon at 96.38%. Raigarh, Korea, Raipur, Korba, Dhamtari, Durg, and Balodabazar have over 93% coverage.

119. Which state celebrated “Dhiyan Di Lohri” to honour newborn girls?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Punjab

Answer: Punjab

In Punjab, ‘Dhiyan Di Lohri’ (Lohri of Daughters) was celebrated in a Jalandhar village, honouring 5,100 newborn girls. Similar celebrations are being organized in various villages across the state. The celebrations aim to strengthen the national ‘Beti Bachao-Beti Padhao’ movement. Celebrating the birth of daughters as a festival reflects progressive social change and promotes saving, educating, and empowering the girl child in society.

120. Alyssa Healy, who recently announced her retirement from all forms of international cricket, belongs to which country?

- [A] England
- [B] South Africa
- [C] New Zealand
- [D] Australia

Answer: Australia

Australia women’s cricket captain Alyssa Healy has announced her retirement from all forms of international cricket ahead of the T20 World Cup 2026. The 35-year-old cited mental fatigue and recurring injuries as reasons for her decision. She confirmed the home series against India in February–March will be her final assignment for Australia. Her final international appearance will be the one-off Test against India in Perth. Alyssa Healy retires as one of the most successful women cricketers and an eight-time World Cup winner.

121. What is the 'Miyawaki method' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] A technique of terrace farming
- [B] A method of urban waste management
- [C] A method of dense afforestation in small areas using native species
- [D] A technique of hydroponic cultivation

Answer: A method of dense afforestation in small areas using native species

The Miyawaki method is increasingly used in cities where green cover has declined over decades, and it is often seen in recent urban greening drives. It is an afforestation technique developed in the 1970s by Japanese botanist Akira Miyawaki. Trees and shrubs are planted very close together, also called the pot plantation method. Only native species are planted, creating a resilient and balanced ecosystem. Forests grow nearly 10 times faster and become very dense with high biodiversity. Recent municipal projects have used this method to convert polluted and barren urban land into green spaces, reducing pollution, improving soil, and enhancing ecological balance.



122. Which American scientist was awarded the Tyler Prize for Environmental Achievement for her work on mycorrhizal fungi?

- [A] Sylvia Earle
- [B] Toby Kiers
- [C] Rachel Carson
- [D] Jane Goodall

Answer: Toby Kiers

American biologist Toby Kiers was awarded the Tyler Prize for Environmental Achievement, often called the “Nobel for the environment”, for her research on mycorrhizal networks. Mycorrhizal networks are underground fungal systems where mycorrhizal fungi connect plant roots via hyphae (fungal threads). These fungi form a symbiotic relationship: plants supply carbohydrates, and fungi provide water and essential nutrients. In forest ecosystems, this underground network is called the Wood Wide Web. They play a crucial ecological role by drawing down 13 billion tonnes of carbon dioxide (CO₂) into soils annually, helping regulate the climate.

123. Which organization released the Employment and Social Trends 2026 report?

- [A] World Bank
- [B] International Labour Organization
- [C] World Economic Forum
- [D] International Monetary Fund

Answer: International Labour Organization

The International Labour Organization (ILO) released its Employment and Social Trends 2026 report in Geneva on 14 January 2026. The report warns that global unemployment will remain at 4.9% in 2026, affecting 186 million people. Employment quality progress has stalled; extreme working poverty declined only 3.1% between 2015–2025. Informal employment is rising, with 2.1 billion workers globally projected to be informally employed by 2026. India accounts for 3% of global manufacturing. India, along with Japan and Korea, is expanding jobs in the renewable energy sector. There is a gap between demand and supply of green-skilled workers in India.

124. Which web portal was launched on the 5th Foundation Day of CSIR-NIScPR to strengthen outreach of validated traditional knowledge?

- [A] SARAL AI
- [B] SVASTIK
- [C] VIGYAN SETU
- [D] CHANAKYA

Answer: SVASTIK

CSIR–National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR) marked its 5th Foundation Day, highlighting science communication and policy research. On this occasion, the SVASTIK portal (Scientifically Validated Societal Traditional Knowledge) was launched. SVASTIK is a national initiative to communicate India’s scientifically validated traditional knowledge to society. It provides content in English, 19



Indian languages, and 5 foreign languages, ensuring wide outreach. The portal brings all SVASTIK content to a single digital platform, improving accessibility and engagement. It strengthens public awareness, policy relevance, and global visibility of India's traditional knowledge systems.

125. Which state has become the first in India to plan a Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD) registry?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Tamil Nadu
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Odisha

Odisha plans to launch India's first state-wide Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD) registry by 31 March, marking a national first. The registry will help the government assess CKD prevalence and design targeted action plans and health programmes. A state task force and a technical working group with experts from health institutes, research bodies, and departments have been formed. All health facilities, from Primary Health Centres (PHCs) to medical colleges, will report Chronic Kidney Disease cases. The National Informatics Centre (NIC) is developing the registry software.

126. Womaniya is a flagship initiative of which platform?

- [A] Government e-Marketplace (GeM)
- [B] Startup India
- [C] National Small Industries Corporation
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Government e-Marketplace (GeM)

Government e-Marketplace (GeM) marked seven years of the Womaniya initiative, which promotes women-led Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) in public procurement. The Womaniya initiative was launched by the Government e-Marketplace (GeM). It was launched on 14 January 2019, Womaniya provides a direct, transparent, fully digital platform for women entrepreneurs and Self-Help Groups (SHGs). As of 14 January 2026, over two lakh women-led MSEs are registered on GeM. These enterprises have secured orders worth over ₹80,000 crore, accounting for 4.7% of total GeM procurement, exceeding the mandated 3%.

127. Where was National Conference on Strategic Trade Controls (NCSTC) 2026 held?

- [A] Chennai
- [B] New Delhi
- [C] Bengaluru
- [D] Hyderabad

Answer: New Delhi

The National Conference on Strategic Trade Controls (NCSTC) 2026 was organised in New Delhi to strengthen India's Strategic Trade Control framework for regulating exports of sensitive and dual-use items. The conference focused on the SCOMET (Special Chemicals, Organisms, Materials, Equipment and Technologies) framework and its role in preventing



proliferation risks while supporting legitimate trade. The conference also addressed export control challenges in emerging and frontier technologies such as semiconductors, quantum technology, aerospace, biotechnology and cyber security.

128. What is the IUCN status of 'Gharial' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Vulnerable
- [B] Endangered
- [C] Critically Endangered
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Critically Endangered

A recent survey across the Ganga River basin recorded 3,037 gharials in 13 rivers despite serious survival threats. Gharial is a freshwater crocodile belonging to the Crocodylia order and Crocodylidae family. Its scientific name is *Gavialis gangeticus* and it mainly feeds on fish. Earlier, its range extended across Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, and Pakistan. Today, major populations survive in the Chambal, Girwa, and Rapti-Naryani rivers. In India, gharial reserves are located in Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, and Rajasthan. As per the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List, it is critically endangered.

129. Where was Madhya Pradesh Regional Artificial Intelligence (AI) Impact Conference 2026 held?

- [A] Jabalpur
- [B] Ujjain
- [C] Indore
- [D] Bhopal

Answer: Bhopal

The Madhya Pradesh Regional AI Impact Conference 2026 held in Bhopal, showcasing practical AI use cases in governance and public service delivery aligned with national AI goals. The conference was part of eight regional events being held nationwide ahead of the India AI Impact Summit 2026 scheduled in New Delhi from 16–20 February 2026. An MoU was signed to expand AI education and skilling, including the establishment of 30 Data and AI Labs in Madhya Pradesh under a national plan for 570 labs in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.

130. Which institution released the report titled “Achieving Efficiencies in MSME Sector through Convergence of Schemes”?

- [A] Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- [B] Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)
- [C] NITI Aayog
- [D] Ministry of MSME

Answer: NITI Aayog

NITI Aayog released the report “Achieving Efficiencies in MSME Sector through Convergence of Schemes” to strengthen government support for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs). It provides a roadmap to improve MSME outcomes by streamlining scheme implementation, enhancing inter-ministerial coordination, and



boosting financial, skill, marketing, and innovation support. The report evaluates existing central and state MSME schemes, examines convergence levels, and identifies best practices from India and abroad.

131. National Startup Day in India is celebrated annually on which day?

- [A] January 14
- [B] January 15
- [C] January 16
- [D] January 17

Answer: January 16

National Startup Day in India is celebrated annually on January 16. National Startup Day on 16 January 2026 marks a decade of the Startup India Initiative, launched in 2016 to energize entrepreneurship in India. Startup India has transformed into one of the world's largest and most diverse startup ecosystems, driving innovation, job creation, and inclusive economic growth. The initiative aligns with India's vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, combining economic modernization with regional uplift and social equity.

132. Similipal National Park is located in which state?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Andhra Pradesh
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Odisha

The latest crocodile census shows an increase in crocodile population in Similipal National Park of Odisha, highlighting successful wildlife conservation. Similipal National Park is located in Mayurbhanj district of Odisha and covers about 2,750 square kilometres. The park is named after the Simul or silk cotton tree found in large numbers. It is a National Park, Tiger Reserve, Wildlife Sanctuary, Biosphere Reserve, and part of the Mayurbhanj Elephant Reserve.

133. The Robotsystem-15 (RBS-15) has been developed by which country?

- [A] Sweden
- [B] France
- [C] Germany
- [D] Australia

Answer: Sweden

Swedish aerospace and defence company Saab showcased the RBS-15 missile's ability to destroy parts of the Russian S-400 air defence system. RBS-15 stands for Robotsystem-15 and is a fire-and-forget anti-ship missile with land-attack capability. It is a surface-to-surface and air-to-surface missile developed by Saab Bofors Dynamics of Sweden. The missile is 4.35 metres long, weighs about 800 kilograms at launch, and flies at subsonic speed of Mach 0.9. It has a range of about 200 kilometres with a 200 kilogram high-explosive warhead. It flies low over the sea, performs evasive manoeuvres, and has low radar and infrared signatures.



134. The Finke River, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Russia
- [B] Australia
- [C] New Zealand
- [D] France

Answer: Australia

The Finke River, called Larapinta by the Arrernte people, is believed to be the world's oldest river system. It is a major but intermittent river located in central Australia. The river originates in the MacDonnell Ranges of the Northern Territory. It forms from the meeting of Davenport Creek and Ormiston Creek. The river flows for about 600 kilometres towards the Simpson Desert in South Australia. Geological evidence dates the river to the Devonian or Carboniferous period, around 300–400 million years ago. For most of the year, it appears as scattered waterholes but becomes fast-flowing after heavy rains.

135. Which state government has launched 'Gruha Lakshmi Digital Marketing' Portal to promote women entrepreneurs?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Karnataka

Karnataka Department of Women and Child Development has launched Gruha Lakshmi Digital Marketing to promote women entrepreneurs. It is a state-backed e-commerce portal showcasing women-made products to national and global markets. The initiative aims to boost women's economic independence and digital inclusion. The portal highlights products from urban and rural women, including artisans and small businesses. Only verified women entrepreneurs are onboarded to ensure trust and quality. It offers a simple, customer-friendly digital interface for buyers.

136. What is the IUCN status of Pufferfish, that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Endangered
- [B] Critically Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Vulnerable

Scientists have confirmed India's first case of freshwater pufferfish poisoning, highlighting a new public health concern. Pufferfish belong to the order Tetraodontiformes and are also called toadfish, patkafish, balloonfish, and fugu. They are omnivorous and benthic, meaning they live and feed near the river bottom. In India, they are mainly found in the Western Ghats and river basins like Ganga, Brahmaputra, and Mahanadi. Freshwater pufferfish species in India are often endemic and indicate healthy river ecosystems. According to International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), pufferfish are listed as Vulnerable.



137. Which state has been recognised by NITI Aayog as the Ginger Capital of India?

- [A] Tripura
- [B] Arunachal Pradesh
- [C] Assam
- [D] Mizoram

Answer: Mizoram

Mizoram Chief Minister Lalduhoma announced direct procurement of ginger and dry broomsticks from farmers starting February 2. The procurement is under the flagship Bana Kaih handholding scheme to ensure assured income to cultivators. The announcement was made during the inauguration of a ginger processing unit at Sairang near Aizawl. NITI Aayog has declared Mizoram as the ginger capital of India due to strong farmer-led production. Ginger cultivation has significantly increased farmers' income and purchasing power.

138. Lake Natron, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Tanzania
- [B] Kenya
- [C] Egypt
- [D] Ethiopia

Answer: Tanzania

Lake Natron in Tanzania glowing blood-red due to extreme volcanic chemistry, creating a striking and deadly natural wonder. Lake Natron is in the Arusha region of northern Tanzania near the Kenya border, in the eastern branch of the East African Rift. It is a highly alkaline soda and saltwater lake fed by the Ewaso Ng'iro River. The lake's red colour comes from salt-loving microorganisms and algae thriving in its caustic waters. Lake Natron was designated a Ramsar Site of International Importance for its unique ecosystem.

139. Kruger National Park, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] South Africa
- [B] Australia
- [C] France
- [D] New Zealand

Answer: South Africa

Recently, Kruger National Park was temporarily closed to day visitors due to severe flooding after prolonged heavy rainfall. Kruger National Park is South Africa's largest and oldest national park, globally famous for wildlife conservation. It is located in northeastern South Africa across Limpopo and Mpumalanga provinces, bordering Mozambique and Zimbabwe. The park was first proclaimed as Sabi Game Reserve in 1898 and became a national park in 1926.

140. Who has become India's 92nd Chess Grandmaster?

- [A] Ashish Chawla
- [B] Aaryan Varshney
- [C] Vikas Sinha



[D] Kush Kapoor

Answer: Aaryan Varshney

Recently, 21-year-old Aaryan Varshney became India's 92nd Grandmaster by securing his final norm at the Andranik Margaryan Memorial Tournament in Armenia. He achieved the Grandmaster (GM) title with a round to spare, adding to India's growing chess legacy. Aaryan was trained entirely at home by his father, Gaurav Varshney, a physics teacher, without any professional coach. He began serious chess training at age seven, focusing on game analysis and practical play. His first rating was 1261 in 2014, rising above 2300 within four years. He won the National Under-13 Championship in 2018. He earned the International Master (IM) title in 2024 through open tournaments.

141. Spituk Gustor festival is celebrated in which state/UT?

[A] Arunachal Pradesh

[B] Ladakh

[C] Assam

[D] Lakshadweep

Answer: Ladakh

Recently, the two-day annual Spituk Gustor festival began at Spituk Monastery in Ladakh. It is observed after a week-long period of prayers and rituals for world peace, prosperity, and victory over evil. The festival marks the end of the harshest phase of Ladakh's extreme winter season. Spituk Gustor is the first monastic festival of Ladakh celebrated each year. The main attraction includes sacred masked dances and unveiling of holy deities for blessings. Ladakh is known as the land of Gonpas, meaning Buddhist monasteries. Spituk Gustor is one of 16 monastic festivals held across Ladakh in different seasons

142. Who are the Chief Guests at India's 77th Republic Day celebrations?

[A] Emmanuel Macron and Olaf Scholz

[B] Ursula von der Leyen and Josep Borrell

[C] Charles Michel and Roberta Metsola

[D] Antonio Luís Santos da Costa and Ursula von der Leyen

Answer: Antonio Luís Santos da Costa and Ursula von der Leyen

Recently, European Council President Antonio Luis Santos da Costa and European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen were invited as Chief Guests at India's 77th Republic Day celebrations. They will visit India from 25–27 January and co-chair the 16th India–European Union (EU) Summit on 27 January. Both leaders will meet President Droupadi Murmu and hold talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi. An India–EU Business Forum will be held alongside the summit. India and the European Union have been strategic partners since 2004. The last summit was held virtually in July 2020.

143. Which state implemented the Panchayat (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act (PESA) nearly 25 years after its statehood in January 2026?

[A] Jharkhand

[B] Bihar

[C] Odisha



[D] Chhattisgarh

Answer: Jharkhand

Recently, Jharkhand implemented rules under the Panchayat (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act (PESA) after 25 years of statehood. PESA is intended to give tribal communities greater control over governance in Fifth Schedule Areas. The law empowers Gram Sabhas to manage local resources, resolve disputes, and preserve customary practices. The implementation covers 13 districts fully, with partial application in three more. Tribal leaders welcome the law but caution that administrative control may dilute true autonomy. The success of PESA will depend on effective and respectful implementation at the village level.

144. Which state government launched the 'Arunodaya' Mission for statewide sickle cell screening in January 2026?

[A] Maharashtra

[B] Gujarat

[C] Uttar Pradesh

[D] Bihar

Answer: Maharashtra

Recently, Maharashtra launched the 'Arunodaya' Mission for statewide sickle cell screening in 21 high-prevalence districts. The drive runs from 15 January to 7 February, covering tribal and high-risk populations. It is implemented by the Maharashtra Public Health and Family Welfare Department under Chief Minister guidance. It provides free screening, diagnostics, medicines, blood transfusions, and telemedicine services. Sickle cell anaemia is a hereditary haemoglobin disorder causing sickle-shaped red blood cells, chronic anaemia, pain crises, infections, and organ damage.

145. The CSIR Integrated Skill Initiative is a flagship programme of which institution?

[A] Department of Science and Technology (DST)

[B] Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)

[C] Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

[D] NITI Aayog

Answer: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)

Recently, the CSIR Integrated Skill Initiative trained over 1.90 lakh individuals through more than 5,200 skill-based programmes. It is a flagship national programme of the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR). It aims to bridge the gap between scientific research, industry needs, and employable skills. The initiative integrates skill development with science and technology using CSIR's research infrastructure. It offers inclusive access to students, researchers, professionals, school dropouts, ITI diploma holders, farmers, and rural communities.

146. Who has been appointed as Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission?

[A] Balakrishna Rao

[B] Vinay Veerendra Chawla

[C] Anil Kumar



[D] Praveen Vashista

Answer: Praveen Vashista

Recently, former Special Secretary (Internal Security), Ministry of Home Affairs, Praveen Vashista, was appointed Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission. He is a 1991-batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer of the Bihar cadre. He took voluntary retirement before his scheduled superannuation in July. The appointment was made by the President of India under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003. The Central Vigilance Commission consists of one Central Vigilance Commissioner and two Vigilance Commissioners.

147. 'Sammakka Saralamma Jatara' tribal festival is celebrated in which state?

[A] Maharashtra

[B] Telangana

[C] Odisha

[D] Karnataka

Answer: Telangana

Recently, Telangana is preparing for the biennial Sammakka–Saralamma Jatara starting 28 January 2026 along with redevelopment of the Medaram sacred area. It is a biennial tribal spiritual festival honouring Sammakka and Saralamma, ancestral goddesses of the Koya Adivasi community. It is recognised as Asia's largest tribal festival and among the world's biggest human congregations. The festival is held at Medaram village in Mulugu district, Telangana. The site lies inside Eturnagaram Wildlife Sanctuary in the Dandakaranya forest belt. It is celebrated during the full moon of the Hindu month of Magh.

148. Which city is the host of 2nd Global Buddhist Summit 2026?

[A] Bengaluru

[B] Hyderabad

[C] Chennai

[D] New Delhi

Answer: New Delhi

Recently, the International Buddhist Confederation (IBC) with the Ministry of Culture will organise the 2nd Global Buddhist Summit on 24–25 January 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. The Summit is held under the theme "Collective Wisdom, United Voice, and Mutual Coexistence". It highlights the relevance of Buddha Dhamma values like compassion, wisdom, harmony, and coexistence. The event builds on the first Summit held in 2023. About 200 global delegates, including Supreme Patriarchs, monks, scholars, and leaders, will participate.

149. The joint Hazardous and Noxious Substances (HNS) response drill was conducted by India and which country in January 2026?

[A] Japan

[B] Australia

[C] Vietnam

[D] Indonesia

**Answer: Japan**

Recently, the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) and Japan Coast Guard (JCG) conducted a joint Hazardous and Noxious Substances (HNS) response drill in Mumbai. Both sides emphasised enhanced maritime cooperation, interoperability, and commitment to a free and open Indo-Pacific. The exercise took place onboard ICG's pollution response vessel ICGS Samudra Prahari. The drill involved ICG Pollution Response Strike Team and JCG National Strike Team, focusing on hazardous chemical spill response. Prior planning, classroom sessions, and rehearsals ensured coordinated operational readiness. The Japanese delegation also visited Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited to learn about India's shipbuilding capabilities.

150. Where was India's first open-sea marine fish farming project launched?

- [A] Arabian Sea
- [B] Laccadive Sea
- [C] Andaman Sea
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Andaman Sea

Recently, India launched its first open-sea marine fish farming project in the Andaman Sea near North Bay, Sri Vijaya Puram. The initiative marks a major step in India's Blue Economy journey, aiming to harness ocean resources for economic growth and livelihoods. The project is a collaboration between the Ministry of Earth Sciences, National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT), and Andaman & Nicobar Islands administration. It focuses on open-sea cultivation of marine finfish and seaweed under natural ocean conditions.

151. Chang'e-6 mission is a lunar exploration program of which country?

- [A] Japan
- [B] China
- [C] Russia
- [D] India

Answer: China

Recently, lunar regolith brought by China's Chang'e-6 mission revealed that the Moon formed from the remains of an ancient collision with Earth. Chang'e-6 is China's first human sampling and return mission from the Moon's far side, part of the Chang'e lunar exploration program. It was launched on 3 May 2024 via Long March-5 rocket from Wenchang Space Launch Center, Hainan. The mission includes an orbiter, returner, lander, and ascender. The lander used sensors (microwave, laser, optical) and collected samples via drilling and a robotic arm. It is China's second successful mission to the Moon's far side after Chang'e-4 in 2019.

152. Bagurumba is a folk dance of which community?

- [A] Bodo
- [B] Santhal
- [C] Khasi
- [D] Gujjar

**Answer: Bodo**

Recently, the Prime Minister of India witnessed a performance of the traditional Bagurumba dance in Assam, with over 10,000 artistes participating. Bagurumba is a folk dance of the Bodo community, inspired by nature and associated with peace, fertility, joy, and collective harmony. It is performed during festivals like Bwisagu (Bodo New Year) and Domasi. The dance symbolises blooming flowers and the harmony between humans and nature.

153. A new hedgehog species, Brandt's hedgehog, has been discovered in which state/UT recently?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Jammu and Kashmir
- [C] Himachal Pradesh
- [D] Lakshadweep

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir

A new hedgehog species, Brandt's hedgehog, has been discovered for the first time in India in Jammu and Kashmir through Deoxyribonucleic Acid analysis and morphological studies. Brandt's hedgehog is a desert hedgehog scientifically known as *Paraechinus hypomelas*. It is native to the Middle East and Central Asia, including Iran, Afghanistan, Pakistan, and Turkmenistan. The species lives in arid and semi-arid habitats such as rocky deserts, scrublands, and dry mountain slopes. It is listed as Least Concern on the International Union for Conservation of Nature Red List.

154. The Chips to Start-up (C2S) Programme was launched by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Science and Technology
- [B] Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
- [C] Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- [D] Ministry of Finance

Answer: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Recently, the Chips to Start-up Programme has shown measurable success in skill building, infrastructure access, and practical chip design support. It is an umbrella capacity-building initiative launched by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology in 2022. The programme has a total outlay of ₹250 crore for five years. It aims to develop 85,000 industry-ready professionals and incubate 25 start-ups with 10 technology transfers. It provides access to Shared Modular Technology laboratories, advanced Electronic Design Automation tools, and semiconductor foundries.

155. Indian Coast Guard Ship Sankalp was indigenously built by which shipyard?

- [A] Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- [B] Cochin Shipyard Limited
- [C] Goa Shipyard Limited
- [D] Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited

Answer: Goa Shipyard Limited

Recently, Indian Coast Guard Ship Sankalp visited Port Louis in Mauritius as part of



overseas deployment in the Indian Ocean Region. It is the fifth Advanced Offshore Patrol Vessel of the Indian Coast Guard, commissioned in 2008. The ship is indigenously built by Goa Shipyard Limited. It is designed for maritime surveillance, Exclusive Economic Zone protection, search and rescue, and law enforcement. The vessel is 105 metres long with an endurance of 6,500 nautical miles and a displacement of about 2,325 tonnes. It has advanced navigation and communication systems and can operate Advanced Light Helicopter and Chetak helicopters.

156. Bor Tiger Reserve is located in which state?

- [A] Maharashtra
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Karnataka
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Maharashtra

Recently, two new safari gates were inaugurated at the Bor Tiger Project in Maharashtra. Bor Tiger Reserve is located in the Wardha district of Maharashtra. It is the smallest tiger reserve in India in terms of area. The reserve covers about 138.12 square kilometres, including the drainage basin of the Bor Dam. It holds strategic importance as it is centrally located among major Bengal tiger habitats.

157. What is 'Indiaphonte bijoyi' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Traditional medicine
- [B] Invasive weed
- [C] Bacteria
- [D] Crustacean

Answer: Crustacean

Recently, a new microscopic crustacean named Indiaphonte bijoyi was discovered in the Kavaratti lagoon of the Lakshadweep islands. It is a tiny crustacean belonging to the family Laophontidae under the Copepoda class. The species lives within sediments of aquatic environments, making it a sediment-dwelling organism. It has a semi-cylindrical and slightly flattened body, broader at the centre and narrowing towards the rear end. It is classified as meiofauna, meaning very small invertebrate animals measuring less than one millimetre in size.

158. Who has been selected for the 'Padmapani Award' at the 11th Ajanta–Ellora International Film Festival?

- [A] A.R. Rahman
- [B] Ilaiyaraaja
- [C] Shankar–Ehsaan–Loy
- [D] M.M. Keeravani

Answer: Ilaiyaraaja

Recently, veteran music composer Ilaiyaraaja was announced as the recipient of the Padmapani Award at the 11th Ajanta–Ellora International Film Festival. The award recognises his unmatched contribution to Indian cinema and music. It includes a



Padmapani memento, a citation certificate, and a cash prize of two lakh rupees. The 11th Ajanta-Ellora International Film Festival will be held from 28 January to 1 February at Mahatma Gandhi Mission, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar. The festival is supported by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting and the Department of Cultural Affairs, Maharashtra.

159. Where was 86th All India Presiding Officers Conference (AIPOC) 2026 held?

- [A] Lucknow
- [B] Bhopal
- [C] Dehradun
- [D] Shimla

Answer: Lucknow

The 86th All India Presiding Officers Conference was held in Lucknow at Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Sabha. The three-day conference (19-21 January) brings together presiding officers, secretaries, and representatives to discuss legislative procedures, parliamentary traditions, House conduct, good governance, and current legislative issues. Key objectives include leveraging technology for transparent, efficient, and citizen-centric legislative processes, capacity building of legislators to improve efficiency, strengthening democratic governance, and enhancing accountability of the legislature towards the public.

160. Which state has emerged as a leading state in India for personal electric vehicle (EV) adoption in 2025?

- [A] Jharkhand
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Kerala

In 2025, Kerala emerged as a leading state in India for personal electric vehicle (EV) adoption. Around 93.4% of EVs in Kerala were personal vehicles, including two- and four-wheelers, showing strong consumer demand. Total vehicle registrations in the state rose by 12.8% in 2025, with approximately 80,261 EVs sold. Kerala has extensive public and private EV charging infrastructure, supporting widespread adoption. The state's EV policy, launched in 2019, provided early incentives, charging networks, and subsidies, encouraging consumer uptake.

161. Which cricket team won Vijay Hazare Trophy title 2026?

- [A] Karnataka
- [B] Vidarbha
- [C] Saurashtra
- [D] Mumbai

Answer: Vidarbha

Vidarbha cricket team won their first Vijay Hazare Trophy by defeating two-time champions Saurashtra by 38 runs. The final was held at the BCCI Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru in a 50-over List A format. Vijay Hazare Trophy is India's premier domestic one-



day tournament; Vidarbha had previously won the Ranji Trophy but not this title.

162. Which state government announced an annual literary award named "Semmozhi Illakiya Virudhu (Classical Language Literary Award)?"

- [A] Tamil Nadu
- [B] Karnataka
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Tamil Nadu

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin announced an annual literary award named "Semmozhi Illakiya Virudhu (Classical Language Literary Award)". The award carries a cash prize of Rs 5 lakh for each language. In the first phase, awards will be given for Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Odiya, Bengali, and Marathi. The initiative was announced following cancellation of the Sahitya Akademi awards due to alleged political intervention by the Union Culture Ministry. The state government will act as patron, while independent experts will handle the selection process.

163. Umbilo Shree Ambalavaanar Alayam temple, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Qatar
- [B] South Africa
- [C] Egypt
- [D] United Arab Emirates

Answer: South Africa

The 151-year-old Umbilo Shree Ambalavaanar Alayam temple in Durban, South Africa, may face discontinuation of civic services due to a pending bill amid fraud allegations. It was built in 1875 by Indian indentured labourers. It is the oldest Hindu temple in Africa. Also called the Cato Manor Second River Temple, it is located on a hill in Cato Manor amidst lush vegetation. The temple complex houses three deities: Ambalavaanar (Lord Shiva), Sri Draupadi Alayam (Mother Goddess), and Phutu/Phutuvan Temple. Its architecture reflects traditional South Indian style with intricate carvings and vibrant colors.

164. Shaya Mohsen Zindani has been appointed as prime minister of which country in January 2026?

- [A] Iran
- [B] Iraq
- [C] Yemen
- [D] Egypt

Answer: Yemen

Yemen's Presidential Leadership Council (PLC) appointed Shaya Mohsen Zindani as the new Prime Minister. The appointment follows the resignation of former Prime Minister Salem bin Breik in mid-January 2026. The change is part of ongoing government restructuring led by the council amid political challenges. The leadership transition occurs



as the country continues complex negotiations over governance, including talks with southern separatists. The new Prime Minister is tasked with stabilising state institutions and navigating Yemen's ongoing political dynamics.

165. Which country is the host of BRICS Plus naval exercise "Will for Peace 2026"?

- [A] Russia
- [B] China
- [C] Iran
- [D] South Africa

Answer: South Africa

India skipped the BRICS Plus naval exercise "Will for Peace 2026" hosted by South Africa, despite holding the BRICS chair in 2026. India stated participation is not automatic or obligatory, as such exercises are ad-hoc initiatives, not institutionalised BRICS activities. BRICS Plus naval exercises are maritime drills involving BRICS members and selected non-BRICS partner countries. They are not mandated under BRICS and are outside official BRICS mechanisms. The 2026 exercise is led by China, with active participation from Russia, Iran, UAE, and South Africa.

166. Which city is the host of Khelo India Winter Games (KIWG) 2026?

- [A] Leh
- [B] Shimla
- [C] Dehradun
- [D] Gangtok

Answer: Leh

Khelo India Winter Games (KIWG) 2026 will be held in Leh from January 21 to 26, 2026, with the opening ceremony on January 21. More than 1,000 participants, including athletes, coaches, and technical officials, will take part in the event. The main venues are Nawang Dorjan Stobdan (NDS) Stadium, the Army rink, and frozen Gupukh's Pond. 472 athletes will compete in ice sports, including skating and hockey, with figure skating introduced this year as an Olympic event. Haryana (62 athletes), Himachal Pradesh (55 athletes), and Ladakh (52 athletes) have the largest representation among 21 states and union territories.

167. Pratas Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which water body?

- [A] Red Sea
- [B] Black Sea
- [C] South China Sea
- [D] Arabian Sea

Answer: South China Sea

A Chinese reconnaissance drone recently flew over the Taiwan-controlled Pratas Islands in the northern South China Sea, which Taiwan described as "provocative and irresponsible." The Pratas Islands, also called the Dongsha Islands, consist of three islands, with Dongsha Island being the only one above sea level; the other two are submerged. The islands have a circular atoll structure made mainly of clastic coral and reef flats.



168. Vadhavan Port, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Andhra Pradesh
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Maharashtra

Answer: Maharashtra

Around 20,000 people in Palghar district protested against the Vadhavan Port project due to environmental concerns. Vadhavan Port is a proposed all-weather greenfield deep-draft major port in Palghar district, about 140 kilometres north of Mumbai, Maharashtra. The port has a natural depth of 20 metres, suitable for large container and bulk cargo ships. It is being developed by Vadhavan Port Project Limited, a Special Purpose Vehicle formed by Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority and Maharashtra Maritime Board. The total project cost is ₹76,220 crore and it is planned to be completed by 2034.

169. Which state has India's largest population of saltwater crocodiles in natural habitat?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Kerala
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Odisha

A drone-based survey by the Odisha Forest and Environment Department shows that the saltwater crocodile population is increasing. The saltwater crocodile is the largest and heaviest living reptile and is also known as the estuarine or Indo-Pacific crocodile. It lives in saltwater, brackish wetlands, rivers, and mangroves. The species is found along India's east coast, Southeast Asia, northern Australia, and Micronesia. In India, it occurs in Odisha, West Bengal, and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with Odisha having the highest population in natural habitat. It is classified as Least Concern by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

170. INS Sudarshini was built by which shipyard?

- [A] Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- [B] Cochin Shipyard Limited
- [C] Goa Shipyard Limited
- [D] Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: Goa Shipyard Limited

The Indian Navy's Sail Training Ship INS Sudarshini will undertake Lokayan 26, a 10-month transoceanic flagship expedition. INS Sudarshini is an indigenously built Sail Training Ship (STS) of the Indian Navy. It was constructed by Goa Shipyard Limited and is based at Kochi, Kerala, under the Southern Naval Command. The ship was commissioned on 27 January 2012. Such ships train sailors to survive independently at sea, handle rough weather, and develop core seamanship skills. INS Sudarshini is a three-masted barque capable of operating under sail or engine power.

171. The 17th edition of Exercise DOSTI was conducted in which country?



- [A] India
- [B] Maldives
- [C] Sri Lanka
- [D] Seychelles

Answer: Maldives

India, Sri Lanka, and the Maldives conducted the 17th edition of the DOSTI Exercise, which concluded on 19 January 2026 in the Maldives. The trilateral Coast Guard exercise was inaugurated on 17 January 2026 in Malé and included a maritime drill on 18 January 2026. It focused on joint training, information sharing, and interoperability to tackle non-traditional maritime security challenges. The exercise supported India's Security and Growth for All in the Region (SAGAR) vision and strengthened regional maritime cooperation.

172. What is the name of the scheme approved by DST to provide long-term financing to spur private investments in research and innovation?

- [A] Startup India Scheme
- [B] Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Scheme
- [C] Make in India Scheme
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Scheme

The Department of Science and Technology (DST) has approved Technology Development Board (TDB) and Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC) as the first Second-Level Fund Managers (SLFMs) under the Research Development and Innovation (RDI) Scheme. The RDI Scheme aims to provide long-term financing or refinancing at low or nil interest rates to encourage private investments in research and innovation. The scheme has a total fund allocation of ₹1 lakh crore.

173. Who is the author of the book Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi-Challenge and Response?

- [A] Surendra Kumar Pachauri
- [B] Ramachandra Guha
- [C] Arundhati Roy
- [D] Shashi Tharoor

Answer: Surendra Kumar Pachauri

Vice President Dr C. P. Radhakrishnan launched the book Chalice of Ambrosia: Ram Janmabhoomi-Challenge and Response in New Delhi. The book is authored by Surendra Kumar Pachauri, a former secretary to the Government of India. Dr Radhakrishnan stated that Ram Mandir at Ayodhya represents a defining moment in India's civilisational journey, where faith, law, and democracy converged. The 2019 Supreme Court verdict fulfilled the aspirations of millions and highlighted the strength of Indian democracy.

174. Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary, recently declared an Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ), is located in which mountain range?

- [A] Aravalli Range



- [B] Vindhya Range
- [C] Western Ghats
- [D] Satpura Range

Answer: Aravalli Range

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change declared Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary in the Aravalli mountain range as an Eco-Sensitive Zone. The move aims to conserve the area's flora and fauna and support indigenous communities living nearby. Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary is located in the Aravalli mountain range, a significant hill system in western India, covering parts of Rajasthan's Rajsamand, Pali, and Udaipur districts. The 0–1 km area around the sanctuary hosts leopards, striped hyenas, jungle cats, Indian pangolins, blue bulls, chinkaras, and birds like painted francolin.

175. The Punjab government has opened its first dog sanctuary in which city?

- [A] Amritsar
- [B] Ludhiana
- [C] Patiala
- [D] Jalandhar

Answer: Ludhiana

Punjab has opened its first Dog Sanctuary in Ludhiana as a pilot project. The initiative will be replicated across the state. The sanctuary aims to reduce dog bite cases in the city. It will operate according to Supreme Court guidelines.

176. Which state government has launched 'Operation Parhar' to dismantle gangster networks?

- [A] Haryana
- [B] Punjab
- [C] Uttar Pradesh
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Punjab

Punjab Police launched 'Operation Parhar' to dismantle the gangster network and make the state gangster-free. 2,000 teams with 12,000 police officials have started raids across Punjab. Police are mapping 60 major gangsters and 1,200 associates involved in criminal activities. The operation targets the complete ecosystem, including financing, logistics, safe houses, weapons, and communication chains. An Anti-Gangster Helpline (93946-93946) has been launched for citizens to report gangster activities. Caller identities will be kept confidential to ensure public participation and safety.

177. Which state is the host of National Paralympic Powerlifting Championship 2026?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Uttar Pradesh
- [C] Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Gujarat

Answer: Uttarakhand

The National Paralympic Powerlifting Championship was inaugurated in Uttarakhand in January 2026. The event was launched virtually from COER University, Roorkee. The



championship focuses on Paralympic powerlifting as a sport of resilience, discipline, courage, and self-confidence. It highlights the abilities and determination of persons with disabilities. The objective is to promote inclusive sports, empower persons with disabilities, and provide national-level competitive exposure.

178. What is the rank of India in Asia Manufacturing Index (AMI) 2026?

- [A] Fourth
- [B] Fifth
- [C] Sixth
- [D] Seventh

Answer: Sixth

India ranked sixth among 11 Asian countries in the Asia Manufacturing Index (AMI) 2026, showing the need to strengthen manufacturing competitiveness. The Asia Manufacturing Index (AMI) measures competitiveness across eight key pillars and 43 sub-parameters. The index is in its third year and is released by Dezan Shira and Associates. Malaysia rose to second place in 2026, replacing Vietnam. Vietnam slipped to third position. These changes indicate intensifying competition within Asia's manufacturing sector.

179. The Central Silk Board works under the administrative control of which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
- [B] Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- [C] Ministry of Textiles
- [D] Ministry of MSME

Answer: Ministry of Textiles

The Government increased the Central Silk Board's financial approval limit to ₹1 crore from ₹50 lakh by amending Rule 22 of the Central Silk Board Rules, 1955. The Central Silk Board is a statutory body established in 1948 by an Act of Parliament. It functions under the Ministry of Textiles, Government of India. The headquarters of the Central Silk Board is located in Bengaluru. It advises the Central Government on development of the silk industry, including import and export of raw silk. It prepares reports on the silk sector as required by the Government.

180. What is the name of the scheme launched by the National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI) to train youth in internet governance?

- [A] Digital India Fellowship Scheme
- [B] Internet Governance Internship & Capacity Building Scheme
- [C] National Cyber Internship Programme
- [D] Bharat Digital Leadership Scheme

Answer: Internet Governance Internship & Capacity Building Scheme

National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI) completed one year of the Internet Governance Internship and Capacity Building Scheme (IGICBS) and marked it with a national event in New Delhi. Internet Governance Internship and Capacity Building Scheme (IGICBS) was launched in 2025 and completed one year in January 2026. It is implemented by National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI) under the Ministry of Electronics and Information



Technology (MeitY). The scheme trains Indian youth in internet governance for participation in national and global policy forums. The programme builds skilled digital leadership and strengthens India's global internet governance role.

181. Which organization released the report on "Global Water Bankruptcy 2026"?

- [A] United Nations Environment Programme
- [B] UN University Institute for Water, Environment and Health
- [C] International Water Management Institute
- [D] World Water Council

Answer: UN University Institute for Water, Environment and Health

The United Nations University Institute for Water, Environment and Health released a report on Global Water Bankruptcy. It warns that the planet has entered a Global Water Bankruptcy era. Water Bankruptcy means long-term water use has exceeded renewable supply and safe limits, causing irreversible damage. Rivers, lakes, aquifers, wetlands, soils, and glaciers are degraded beyond full recovery. This differs from water stress, which is high demand but largely reversible. It also differs from water crisis, which is temporary and manageable with restoration. Key causes include chronic overuse of water resources, dam-driven overexpansion, ecological degradation, and climate change intensifying existing water stress.

182. Metadon ghorpadei and Metadon reemeri, that were recently seen in news, belongs to which species?

- [A] Ant fly
- [B] Spider
- [C] Fish
- [D] Frog

Answer: Ant fly

Researchers from Kerala and Tamil Nadu discovered two new rare ant fly species from India. The species are Metadon ghorpadei and Metadon reemeri of subfamily Microdontinae (Syrphidae). Their larvae live inside ant nests and feed on ant brood, a behaviour called myrmecophily. Metadon ghorpadei was found in Delhi's northern ridge, a disturbed urban forest of the Aravalli range. Metadon reemeri was discovered in the Siruvani hills of the Western Ghats, Tamil Nadu. The discovery highlights the biodiversity value of urban forests and protected hotspots.

183. Atal Pension Yojana (APY) was launched in which year?

- [A] 2015
- [B] 2018
- [C] 2022
- [D] 2024

Answer: 2015

The Union Cabinet approved continuation of Atal Pension Yojana (APY) up to Financial Year (FY) 2030–31. The scheme will receive government support for promotional, developmental activities, and gap funding. Promotional efforts will expand awareness and



coverage among unorganised sector workers. Gap funding will ensure financial viability and long-term sustainability of Atal Pension Yojana (APY). It supports financial inclusion and India's transition towards a pensioned society. It was launched on 9 May 2015. APY offers a guaranteed pension of ₹1,000–₹5,000 per month after age 60. As of 19 January 2026, APY has over 8.66 crore subscribers, strengthening Viksit Bharat @2047 vision.

184. The SAMPANN pension management system has been integrated with which digital platform?

- [A] DigiLocker
- [B] UMANG
- [C] BharatNet
- [D] e-Shram

Answer: UMANG

SAMPANN pension management system has been integrated with the UMANG (Unified Mobile Application for New-age Governance) platform. The initiative helps pensioners access Pension Payment Order (PPO) number and Life Certificate (LC) validity anytime. It is developed by the Office of the Controller General of Communication Accounts. The integration improves ease of access, transparency, and digital service delivery for pensioners. UMANG provides a single platform for Central, State, and Local Government services under Digital India. SAMPANN (System for Accounting and Management of Pension) was dedicated to the nation in 2018. It digitises the entire pension lifecycle, ensuring pensioner-centric governance and direct bank payments.

185. Which city became the first in Uttar Pradesh to achieve 100% scientific processing of municipal solid waste?

- [A] Meerut
- [B] Varanasi
- [C] Prayagraj
- [D] Lucknow

Answer: Lucknow

Lucknow became Uttar Pradesh's first zero fresh waste dump city after launching the Shivari Solid Waste Management Plant under Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban (SBM-U). The new plant processes 700 metric tonnes per day, taking total capacity to over 2,100 metric tonnes daily. Lucknow Municipal Corporation (LMC) and Bhumi Green Energy operate three plants of equal capacity. Waste is segregated into organic (55%) and inorganic (45%) fractions. Organic waste is converted into compost and biogas, while inorganic waste is recycled or made into Refuse Derived Fuel (RDF).

186. Kaladi, that was recently seen in news, is a Geographical Indication (GI) tagged dairy product of which state/UT?

- [A] Jammu and Kashmir
- [B] Uttarakhand
- [C] Haryana
- [D] Lakshadweep

Answer: Jammu and Kashmir



Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh directed upscaling of Kaladi, a Geographical Indication (GI) tagged dairy product of Udhampur, Jammu and Kashmir. Kaladi will be promoted under the One District One Product (ODOP) initiative for national and global markets. Focus is on value addition and shelf-life enhancement without changing taste, texture, or nutrition Council of Scientific and Industrial Research–Central Food Technological Research Institute (CSIR-CFTRI), Mysuru, and CSIR–Indian Institute of Integrative Medicine (CSIR-IIIM), Jammu, will jointly work on the project. Kaladi is traditionally made from raw full-fat milk and is known as the “mozzarella of Jammu”.

187. Who has been appointed as the head coach of the senior Indian women’s football team?

- [A] Priya PV
- [B] Crispin Chettri
- [C] Amelia Valverde
- [D] Mario Aguiar

Answer: Amelia Valverde

The All India Football Federation appointed Amelia Valverde as head coach of the senior Indian women’s football team. Amelia Valverde is 39 years old and hails from Costa Rica. She has joined the Indian team camp in Antalya, Türkiye. The team is preparing for the Asian Football Confederation (AFC) Women’s Asian Cup Australia 2026. The tournament is scheduled to be held in March 2026. Her appointment aims to strengthen the performance of the Indian women’s team, also known as the Blue Tigresses.

188. The Kamchatka Peninsula, recently in news due to record-breaking snowfall, is located in which country?

- [A] Russia
- [B] China
- [C] Norway
- [D] Switzerland

Answer: Russia

Russia’s Far Eastern Kamchatka Peninsula is facing record-breaking snowfall due to powerful winter storms. It is located between the Sea of Okhotsk to the west and the Pacific Ocean and Bering Sea to the east. Kamchatka is part of Kamchatka Krai in Russia. It is one of the world’s largest peninsulas and a major zone of geothermal activity. The region lies on the Pacific Ring of Fire and has over 150 volcanoes, including 29 active ones. The “Volcanoes of Kamchatka” is a United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) World Heritage Site.

189. Where was the 2026 World Economic Forum (WEF) Annual Meeting held?

- [A] Paris, France
- [B] Davos, Switzerland
- [C] London, United Kingdom
- [D] New Delhi, India

Answer: Davos, Switzerland

The 2026 World Economic Forum (WEF) Annual Meeting was held in Davos, Switzerland,



from January 19–23, 2026. The 56th annual meeting focused on the theme "A Spirit of Dialogue," bringing together global leaders to address economic, geopolitical, and technology-driven risks. It was established in 1971 and promotes the stakeholder theory for inclusive and sustainable growth. The Davos meeting provides a platform for dialogue and exchange of ideas, not formal trade negotiations. It discusses key global issues like climate change, economic stability, and global security.

190. Muna Island, that was recently seen in news, is located in which country?

- [A] Indonesia
- [B] Japan
- [C] China
- [D] Philippines

Answer: Indonesia

Researchers found the world's oldest known rock art, a painted human hand outline, inside a cave on Muna Island, Indonesia, dated to at least 67,800 years ago. Muna Island is located in Southeast Sulawesi province of Indonesia and covers about 1,704 square kilometres. The island has a hilly landscape rising up to about 445 metres, with teak forests in the north and northeast. Muna Island is known for rich culture, natural beauty, forests, and clean beaches

191. Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana was launched under which campaign?

- [A] Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao
- [B] Bal Vivah Mukti Bharat
- [C] Skill India
- [D] FairStart

Answer: Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao

Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY) was launched on 22 January 2015 under the Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao campaign of the Government of India. It is a small savings scheme where deposits earn government-notified interest, currently at 8.2 percent per annum. The scheme is low-risk, with the Government guaranteeing both principal and interest. SSY aims to support education and marriage expenses of the girl child. Since inception, over 4.53 crore accounts have been opened with deposits exceeding ₹3.33 lakh crore as of December 2025. The scheme promotes financial security, women empowerment, and social transformation.

192. Lambada community, that was recently seen in news, is mainly found in which Indian states?

- [A] Rajasthan and Gujarat
- [B] Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Telangana and Andhra Pradesh
- [D] Odisha and Chhattisgarh

Answer: Telangana and Andhra Pradesh

The Supreme Court is re-examining the long-standing dispute over Scheduled Tribe (ST) status of the Lambada community in Telangana. Lambadas are also known as Sugalis or Banjaras and are recognised as a Scheduled Tribe. They are mainly spread across



Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. The community is believed to have originated from the Marwar region of Rajasthan. Traditionally, they were semi-nomadic traders transporting goods, but this declined during British rule. They speak “Gor Boli”, also called Lambadi language.

193. Who has been selected for the Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development for 2025?

- [A] Ellen Johnson Sirleaf
- [B] Graca Machel
- [C] Winnie Madikizela-Mandela
- [D] Leymah Gbowee

Answer: Graca Machel

Mozambican humanitarian and rights activist Graça Machel has been selected for the Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development for 2025. The award decision was made by an international jury chaired by former National Security Advisor Shivshankar Menon. She was chosen for path-breaking work in education, health, nutrition, economic empowerment, and humanitarian action. The award carries a cash prize of ₹1 crore, a citation, and a trophy. She led a landmark United Nations (UN) study in the 1990s on the impact of armed conflict on children.

194. ‘Parakram Diwas’ is observed to commemorate the birth anniversary of which freedom fighter?

- [A] Mahatma Gandhi
- [B] Bhagat Singh
- [C] Subhas Chandra Bose
- [D] Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Answer: Subhas Chandra Bose

Ministry of Culture, Government of India, is organizing Parakram Diwas-2026 from 23 to 25 January 2026. The event marks the 129th birth anniversary of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose, a great freedom fighter. The programme aims to inspire youth with Netaji’s ideals of courage, unity, and patriotism.

195. What is the new name of the Uttar Pradesh Governor’s residence?

- [A] Lok Bhavan
- [B] Jan Bhavan
- [C] Raj Sadan
- [D] Praja Bhavan

Answer: Jan Bhavan

Uttar Pradesh Governor’s official residence has been renamed from Raj Bhavan to Jan Bhavan. The name change was announced by the state government and is now in effect. The decision follows guidelines issued by the Union Ministry of Home Affairs. The new name will be used for all official and statutory purposes. The move aims to standardise the names of Governors’ residences across India. It reflects a nationwide initiative to bring uniformity in official nomenclature.



196. Operation Trashi-I is a counter-terrorism operation conducted in which State/Union Territory?

- [A] Punjab
- [B] Himachal Pradesh
- [C] Jammu & Kashmir
- [D] Uttarakhand

Answer: Jammu & Kashmir

Operation Trashi-I entered its fourth day in January 2026 in the dense forests of Kishtwar district, Jammu and Kashmir. It is a multi-day counter-terrorism and area-domination operation in the Chatroo forest region. The operation is jointly conducted by the Indian Army, Jammu and Kashmir Police including Special Operations Group (SOG), and Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF). It aims to track and neutralise terrorists, destroy hideouts and logistics, and disrupt infiltration routes.

197. Which country joined the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI) in January 2026??

- [A] Spain
- [B] France
- [C] Germany
- [D] Italy

Answer: Spain

Spain has formally joined the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI), strengthening its engagement in the Indo-Pacific region. The Declaration of Accession was handed over by Spanish Foreign Minister José Manuel Albares to External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar in New Delhi. Spain announced upgrading relations with India to a strategic association, the highest level of bilateral partnership. It was launched by India in 2019, IPOI promotes a free, open, and rules-based Indo-Pacific with maritime security and cooperation.

198. Which city is the host of 2nd Global Buddhist Summit 2026?

- [A] Mumbai
- [B] New Delhi
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Chennai

Answer: New Delhi

The 2nd Global Buddhist Summit is scheduled to take place in January 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. It is organised by the International Buddhist Confederation (IBC) with the Ministry of Culture, Government of India. The theme is "Collective Wisdom, United Voice, Mutual Coexistence". The summit aims to promote Buddhist values like compassion, wisdom, harmony, and peace.

199. Striped Tiger Butterfly has been declared as the State Butterfly of which Union Territory?

- [A] Delhi
- [B] Puducherry
- [C] Chandigarh
- [D] Jammu & Kashmir

Answer: Chandigarh



The State Board of Wildlife (SBWL) declared the Striped Tiger Butterfly as the State Butterfly of Chandigarh. The decision was taken in a meeting chaired by Union Territory (UT) Administrator Gulab Chand Kataria. The move aims to promote biodiversity conservation and public awareness in the Union Territory. The Forest and Wildlife Department was directed to run awareness campaigns at public places. The Sukhomajri Project and Sukhna Lake watershed were praised for soil, moisture, and silt management.

200. Bembla Irrigation Project, that was recently seen in news, is located in which state?

- [A] Kerala
- [B] Maharashtra
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Maharashtra

The Bembla Irrigation Project is located in Yavatmal district of Maharashtra in the drought-prone Vidarbha region. It is a multipurpose irrigation project under the Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY) and Accelerated Irrigation Benefit Programme (AIBP). The project involves a dam on the Bembla River, a tributary of the Wardha River, near Babhulgaon. It aims to create irrigation potential for about 52,543 hectares benefiting over 100 villages. By early 2026, more than 95% canal and distribution works were completed with micro-irrigation focus.

201. Which state government announced the 'Atal Vichal Agrabami' scheme to support research scholars?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Tripura
- [C] Sikkim
- [D] Manipur

Answer: Assam

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma announced the 'Atal Vichal Agrabami Assam' scheme to support research scholars. The scheme will provide ₹25,000 per month to research scholars and ₹40,000 per month to Divyang research scholars. It will be formally launched on 11 February 2026. The initiative aims to promote high-quality research, innovation, and academic excellence. It seeks to reduce financial constraints related to research materials, fieldwork, and living costs.

202. What is 'Haven-1' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] India's first lunar orbiter
- [B] World's first commercial space station
- [C] China's modular space lab
- [D] NASA's Mars research station

Answer: World's first commercial space station

Haven-1 is planned as the world's first commercial space station in low-Earth orbit (LEO). It is a single-module station and a precursor to the larger multi-module Haven-2. It is being developed by American aerospace company Vast with support from NASA and private



partners. It will host short-duration missions for microgravity research, in-space manufacturing, and orbital tourism.

203. Akatsuki mission, also called PLANET-C was operated by which space agency?

- [A] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- [B] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- [C] European Space Agency (ESA)
- [D] Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

Answer: Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

Japan officially ended the Akatsuki mission after losing contact with the spacecraft for over a year. Akatsuki, also called PLANET-C or Venus Climate Orbiter (VCO), was operated by Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA). It was the only active spacecraft orbiting Venus, studying volcanism and atmospheric dynamics, especially super-rotation.

204. Borax is primarily composed of which elements?

- [A] Boron, sodium, and oxygen
- [B] Sodium, chlorine, and hydrogen
- [C] Calcium, boron, and nitrogen
- [D] Potassium, boron, and sulfur

Answer: Boron, sodium, and oxygen

A 19-year-old college girl in Tamil Nadu died after consuming borax for weight loss. Borax is also called sodium tetraborate decahydrate, a white powdery mineral. It is composed of boron, sodium, and oxygen. It is used in glass and pottery glazes, metallurgy, welding flux, fertilizer additive, soap, disinfectant, mouthwash, and water softener. It naturally occurs in evaporite deposits from seasonal lake evaporation and can be synthetically produced.

205. Phulkari embroidery, that was recently seen in news, originated in which region?

- [A] Rajasthan and Gujarat
- [B] Maharashtra and Karnataka
- [C] Punjab and Haryana
- [D] Uttar Pradesh and Bihar

Answer: Punjab and Haryana

An exhibition showcasing over 40 rare pre-Partition textiles highlights how phulkari was deeply woven into women's daily lives and social traditions. Phulkari, meaning "flower work," is a traditional embroidery of undivided Punjab, covering present-day Punjab, Haryana, and Pakistan. The term appeared in 18th-century Punjabi literature and is linked to the Iranian art of gulkari.

206. The State of Finance for Nature 2026 report was released by which organization?

- [A] World Economic Forum (WEF)
- [B] United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
- [C] World Bank
- [D] International Monetary Fund (IMF)

Answer: United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)



The State of Finance for Nature 2026 report released by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) highlights a major global imbalance favouring nature-negative finance. Nature-positive finance supports environmental conservation through Nature-based Solutions (NbS), while nature-negative finance harms ecosystems. In 2023, nature-negative finance reached 7.3 trillion US dollars, nearly 30 times higher than the 220 billion US dollars spent on NbS. About 90% of NbS funding comes from public sources, while private finance largely flows to fossil fuels and heavy industries.

207. The humanoid robot ASC ARJUN was introduced at which railway station by Indian railways?

- [A] Chennai Central
- [B] New Delhi
- [C] Visakhapatnam
- [D] Howrah

Answer: Visakhapatnam

Indian Railways introduced a humanoid robot named ASC ARJUN at Visakhapatnam Railway Station to enhance passenger safety, security, and service. This is the first deployment of its kind on the Indian Railways network, reflecting a focus on innovation and indigenous development. It assists RPF personnel with intrusion detection via Face Recognition System, AI-based crowd monitoring, and real-time alerts. The robot can make automated announcements in English, Hindi, and Telugu, guide passengers, and improve safety awareness.

208. National Girl Child Day is celebrated every year on which day?

- [A] January 24
- [B] January 25
- [C] January 26
- [D] January 27

Answer: January 24

National Girl Child Day is celebrated every year in India on January 24 to focus on the rights, education, health, nutrition, and overall welfare of girls. It was initiated in 2008 by the Ministry of Women and Child Development (MWCD) to raise awareness about gender discrimination and promote equal opportunities. The day highlights the critical role of girls in building a brighter, equitable future and aligns with India's vision of women-led development and Viksit Bharat by 2047. It addresses issues such as gender bias, female foeticide, poor child sex ratio, child marriage, and barriers to education and health.

209. One District One Product (ODOP) was first launched in which state?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Uttar Pradesh

Answer: Uttar Pradesh

One District One Product (ODOP) empowers local artisans, revives traditional skills, and creates livelihoods. The initiative has scaled nationwide, transforming more than 770



districts into economic hubs. It was started in Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh (2018) with brassware as the district's signature product. ODOP is now India's most celebrated local economic transformation program. E-commerce initiatives like the Government e-Marketplace (GeM)-ODOP Bazaar showcase and promote India's finest ODOP products.

210. Operation Megaburu is an anti-Maoist counter-insurgency operation conducted in which state?

- [A] Chhattisgarh
- [B] Odisha
- [C] Jharkhand
- [D] Andhra Pradesh

Answer: Jharkhand

Operation Megaburu is a large-scale anti-Maoist counter-insurgency operation conducted in the Saranda forest region of West Singhbhum, Jharkhand. It was launched in January 2026. It targeted Maoist strongholds in the Kumdi area under Kiriburu police station limits. The operation involved Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) elite Commando Battalion for Resolute Action (CoBRA) units and Jharkhand Police. It aimed to neutralise top Communist Party of India (Maoist) leadership, dismantle command structures, and clear remaining Maoist pockets.

211. The Board of Peace is an initiative of which country?

- [A] China
- [B] United States
- [C] France
- [D] India

Answer: United States

India did not attend the ceremonial launch of the Board of Peace, even though it had received a formal invitation from U.S. President Donald Trump. The Board of Peace is a United States-led intergovernmental initiative announced by President Donald Trump during the World Economic Forum (WEF) held in Davos, Switzerland. The primary mandate of the Board is to oversee post-war reconstruction and governance of the Gaza Strip through a technocratic administrative framework rather than traditional political mechanisms. Its long-term vision includes expanding its role to address and resolve global conflicts in situations where existing international institutions are perceived to have failed.

212. Recently, the world's oldest known rock art was discovered in which country?

- [A] Indonesia
- [B] China
- [C] India
- [D] Japan

Answer: Indonesia

World's oldest known rock art discovered in Liang Metanduno cave, Muna Island, Indonesia. The artwork is a hand stencil with fingers deliberately narrowed to resemble a



claw or animal feature. Uranium-series dating shows the calcium carbonate layer covering the artwork is at least 67,800 years old. This surpasses the previous record of 51,200 years for a wild pig painting in Leang Karampuang cave, South Sulawesi.

213. Which river has emerged as the second major river after the Chambal with the highest number of gharials (fish-eating crocodiles)?

- [A] Ghagra
- [B] Gandak
- [C] Son
- [D] Kosi

Answer: Gandak

The Gandak River, flowing along the India–Nepal border through West Champaran in Bihar, has become the second-largest habitat of gharials after the Chambal River. Sustained conservation efforts by the Wildlife Trust of India (WTI) and the Department of Environment, Forest and Climate Change have driven this recovery. Adult gharial numbers in the Gandak increased from 54 in 2015 to over 400 in 2025, while the total population including juveniles crossed 1,000. The Chambal River remains the largest habitat with over 2,400 gharials.

214. Which government department has been named a finalist for the 2026 Franz Edelman Award for its Anna Chakra initiative?

- [A] Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
- [B] Department of Food and Public Distribution
- [C] Department of Economic Affairs
- [D] Department of Consumer Affairs

Answer: Department of Food and Public Distribution

The Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD) has been named a finalist for the 2026 Franz Edelman Award for its Anna Chakra initiative. Anna Chakra is a supply chain optimisation tool developed under India's Public Distribution System (PDS). It is an operations research–based decision support system that optimises state-wise food grain logistics. The initiative was created through a Government–United Nations–Academia partnership involving DFPD, the United Nations World Food Programme (WFP) in India, and Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi. It uses advanced algorithms to identify optimal transport routes and ensure smooth movement of food grains across the supply chain.

215. National Girl Child Day is observed every year on which day?

- [A] January 22
- [B] January 23
- [C] January 24
- [D] January 25

Answer: January 24

National Girl Child Day is observed across India on 24 January to promote awareness about the rights, education, health, safety, and overall welfare of girls. It highlights India's



commitment to gender equality and the need to address issues like gender bias, child marriage, and unequal opportunities. The day was first observed in 2008 after being initiated by the Ministry of Women and Child Development, Government of India. Its objective is to draw attention to challenges faced by girls and promote awareness about education, nutrition, health, and legal rights.

216. Which city is the host of Wings India 2026, Asia's largest civil aviation event?

- [A] Hyderabad
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Mumbai
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: Hyderabad

Wings India 2026, Asia's largest civil aviation event is scheduled to take place from 28–31 January 2026 at Begumpet Airport, Hyderabad. The Theme is "Indian Aviation: Paving the Future – From Design to Deployment, Manufacturing to Maintenance, Inclusivity to Innovation and Safety to Sustainability." More than 20 countries' ministerial-level delegations and leading global and domestic aviation companies such as Airbus, Boeing, HAL, Dassault, Adani, Etihad, Air India, IndiGo, and Akasa Air will participate.

217. Veer Gatha 5.0 is a joint initiative of which ministries?

- [A] Ministry of Culture and Ministry of Education
- [B] Ministry of Youth Affairs and Ministry of Education
- [C] Ministry of Home Affairs and Ministry of Tourism
- [D] Ministry of Defence and Ministry of Education

Answer: Ministry of Defence and Ministry of Education

Minister of State for Defence Sanjay Seth and Minister of State for Education Jayant Chaudhary felicitated winners at the Veer Gatha 5.0 awards ceremony in New Delhi. Veer Gatha 5.0 is a joint initiative of the Ministries of Defence and Education, celebrating the courage of Gallantry awardees. This year, 100 winners were selected from 91 schools across 18 countries under three categories. Each winner received a cash prize of ₹10,000 and an opportunity to witness the Republic Day Parade 2026 at Kartavya Path as special guests. Veer Gatha was launched in 2021 as part of Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav.

218. Indian Air Force Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla received which gallantry award during the 77th Republic Day celebrations?

- [A] Ashoka Chakra
- [B] Shaurya Chakra
- [C] Vir Chakra
- [D] Kirti Chakra

Answer: Ashoka Chakra

Indian Air Force Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla was conferred the Ashoka Chakra, India's highest peacetime gallantry award, by President Droupadi Murmu during the 77th Republic Day celebrations at Kartavya Path. Group Captain Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair will be awarded the Kirti Chakra. Shubhanshu Shukla travelled to the International Space



Station (ISS) in 2025 as part of the Axiom-4 mission, becoming the second Indian in space after Wing Commander Rakesh Sharma. The award recognises his exceptional courage, leadership, presence of mind and swift decision-making under demanding space mission conditions.

219. The World Economic Forum (WEF) announced the establishment of its third Centre for the Fourth Industrial Revolution in which Indian state?

- [A] Gujarat
- [B] Kerala
- [C] Odisha
- [D] Andhra Pradesh

Answer: Andhra Pradesh

The World Economic Forum (WEF) is establishing five new Centres for the Fourth Industrial Revolution, including one in Andhra Pradesh, India. India already has two such centres: in Mumbai and Telangana. The Fourth Industrial Revolution Network, launched in 2017, connects national and thematic centres worldwide to advance responsible development of emerging technologies. Other new centres will be in France, the U.K., and the UAE.

220. Sepahijala Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

- [A] Assam
- [B] Tripura
- [C] Mizoram
- [D] Manipur

Answer: Tripura

The Tripura Forest Minister announced that the state has received over ₹57 crore for the modernisation and further development of Sepahijala Wildlife Sanctuary. Sepahijala Wildlife Sanctuary is located in the Sepahijala district of Tripura. The sanctuary includes important water bodies such as Abasarika Lake and Amrit Sagar Lake. Clouded Leopard National Park is a part of the Sepahijala Wildlife Sanctuary.

221. The Remount and Veterinary Corps (RVC) is a specialised corps of which force?

- [A] Indian Air Force
- [B] Indian Navy
- [C] Indian Army
- [D] Border Security Force

Answer: Indian Army

More animals were showcased during the Republic Day Parade, highlighting the role of the Indian Army's Remount and Veterinary Corps (RVC). Remount and Veterinary Corps (RVC) is a specialised corps responsible for the breeding, rearing, training and veterinary care of Army animals such as horses, mules and dogs. It ensures operational readiness of animals for combat, logistics, reconnaissance and counter-terrorism operations. The headquarters of the RVC is located in Meerut.

222. Who became the first Indian to win the Wiley Research Heroes Prize 2025?

- [A] Soumya Swaminathan



- [B] Chandrakant Lahariya
- [C] Randeep Guleria
- [D] Vikram Patel

Answer: Chandrakant Lahariya

Dr. Chandrakant Lahariya, former staff member of the World Health Organisation (WHO), has won the Wiley Research Heroes Prize 2025. He is the first and only Indian to receive this global honour so far. The award received over 2,000 nominations from across the world. He won in the category "Impact Beyond Academia", recognising research that influences policy and society. Dr. Lahariya is among five researchers globally honoured this year for outstanding research and policy impact.

223. In January 2026, which state's police force received the President's Police Colour Award (Nishaan)?

- [A] Sikkim
- [B] Jharkhand
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Manipur

Answer: Sikkim

In January 2026, Sikkim Police has been conferred the President's Police Colour Award (Nishaan). The award recognises outstanding service, professionalism, bravery, discipline, and dedication. Nishaan is worn with pride on the left sleeve of the uniform. Since Independence, only 14 states have received this prestigious award. Sikkim becomes the 15th state overall and 3rd in the North East to receive it.

224. Which country officially withdrew from the World Health Organization (WHO) in January 2026?

- [A] Canada
- [B] India
- [C] United States
- [D] Russia

Answer: United States

The U.S. has officially withdrawn from the World Health Organization (WHO), one year after President Donald Trump announced the exit. The WHO is the United Nations' specialized health agency coordinating global responses to health threats like mpox, Ebola, and polio. The U.S. owes WHO about \$280 million in unpaid dues and voluntary contributions. The U.S. no longer participates in WHO committees, governance, or technical working groups, including global flu monitoring.

225. ExoMiner++ is a new deep learning software developed by which space organization?

- [A] European Space Agency (ESA)
- [B] National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- [C] Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- [D] Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

Answer: National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)

ExoMiner++ is a new deep learning software designed to discover exoplanets. It is



developed by NASA (National Aeronautics and Space Administration). It analyses data from both the Kepler and TESS (Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite) missions. The software scans stellar “light curves” for dips in brightness caused by planets transiting in front of their stars. Unlike standard black-box models, ExoMiner++ is an explainable AI, offering probability scores and reasoning to help astronomers verify and trust its findings.

226. Which state government has implemented the Uniform Civil Code (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026?

- [A] Uttarakhand
- [B] Madhya Pradesh
- [C] Gujarat
- [D] Rajasthan

Answer: Uttarakhand

The Uttarakhand Government has implemented the Uniform Civil Code (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026, following approval by the Governor, and it has come into force with immediate effect. The ordinance was promulgated under Article 213 of the Constitution of India to introduce procedural, administrative, and penal reforms to the UCC Act, 2024 for smoother and more transparent implementation. The amendments aim to promote women’s empowerment, protect children’s rights, ensure equality in civil rights, and simplify legal procedures.

227. The European Atomic Energy Community (Euratom) was established under which treaty?

- [A] Maastricht Treaty, 1992
- [B] Lisbon Treaty, 2007
- [C] Paris Treaty, 1951
- [D] Treaty of Rome, 1957

Answer: Treaty of Rome, 1957

India and the European Union (EU) agreed to strengthen cooperation on peaceful uses of nuclear energy under the India–Euratom agreement. The European Atomic Energy Community (Euratom) was established in 1957 under the Treaty of Rome. Its objective is to develop a common market for the peaceful use of atomic energy across Europe. Euratom promotes nuclear energy development at a European level, excluding military nuclear materials.

228. What is *Lepidagathis konkanensis* that was recently seen in news?

- [A] A new species of flowering plant
- [B] A type of Virus
- [C] Traditional medicine
- [D] Invasive weed

Answer: A new species of flowering plant

Researchers discovered a new wildflower species named *Lepidagathis konkanensis* in the Konkan region of Maharashtra. It was found in Ratnagiri district during a floristic survey of lateritic plateaus, which are iron-rich and harsh habitats. The species is currently known from a very small area of less than 65 square kilometres. The name honours the Konkan



region, which is isolated by the Arabian Sea and Sahyadri Mountains. Scientists recommend its status as Data Deficient under the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

229. Mark Tully, who recently passed away, was associated with which field?

- [A] Politics
- [B] Sports
- [C] Literature
- [D] Journalism

Answer: Journalism

Veteran journalist Mark Tully passed away in Delhi at the age of 90 on January 25, 2026. He was a long-time British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC) correspondent and became a household name in South Asia. Born in Kolkata in 1935, he later returned to India as BBC's Assistant Representative in New Delhi. He covered major events like the 1965 and 1971 India-Pakistan wars, Emergency of 1975, Punjab insurgency, and Operation Blue Star. He was knighted in 2002 and awarded the Padma Bhushan in 2005, earning the reputation as the "voice of India."

230. Which state bagged the 1st position in the PESA (Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas) State Rankings among the Fifth Schedule Areas?

- [A] Madhya Pradesh
- [B] Himachal Pradesh
- [C] Maharashtra
- [D] Odisha

Answer: Maharashtra

PESA (Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas) State Rankings for 2024-25 were released. Maharashtra secured 1st position, Madhya Pradesh 2nd, and Himachal Pradesh 3rd among the 10 States with Fifth Schedule Areas. The rankings assess implementation of the PESA Act, which strengthens Gram Sabhas and Panchayats in Scheduled Areas. The rankings aim to promote Gram Sabha-centric self-governance, evidence-based policy interventions, and identify areas needing focused support. The initiative reflects a collective commitment of the Centre and States for outcome-oriented PESA implementation.

231. Where was the 12th edition of Smile International Film Festival for Children and Youth held?

- [A] New Delhi
- [B] Chennai
- [C] Hyderabad
- [D] Bengaluru

Answer: New Delhi

The 12th edition of Smile International Film Festival for Children and Youth (SIFFCY) has begun in New Delhi. The seven-day festival is organised by Smile Foundation in collaboration with the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities. Smile International Film Festival for Children and Youth (SIFFCY) 2026 focuses on diversity,



equity, and inclusion, encouraging children and youth to engage with personal, social, moral, and global issues. The festival showcases films highlighting disability inclusion, equity, and diversity, including productions made by disabled children for the first time.

232. What is the theme of Vande Mataram Coastal Cyclothon 2026 organised by Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)?

- [A] Coastal Security for All
- [B] Surakshit Tat, Samridh Bharat
- [C] Vande Mataram – 150 Years
- [D] Fitness and Patriotism

Answer: Surakshit Tat, Samridh Bharat

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) organised the 2nd edition of Vande Mataram Coastal Cyclothon 2026. The 25-day cyclothon commemorates 150 years of Vande Mataram and will continue until 22nd February 2026. The Theme is "Surakshit Tat, Samridh Bharat". 148 CISF personnel, including 65 women, are participating to promote patriotism, national consciousness, coastal security awareness, and community engagement.

233. Which species is the natural host of "Nipah Virus" that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Rodents
- [B] Pigs
- [C] Fruit bats
- [D] Migratory birds

Answer: Fruit bats

India recently confirmed two Nipah virus cases in West Bengal, with authorities containing the situation through surveillance and airport screenings. Nipah virus (NiV) is a zoonotic virus, meaning it spreads from animals to humans and also through contaminated food or human-to-human contact. Fruit bats of the Pteropodidae family are the natural hosts of Nipah virus. It is listed by the World Health Organization (WHO) under the Research and Development (R&D) Blueprint due to its epidemic potential.

234. Maia 200 is an in-house artificial intelligence processor developed by which organization?

- [A] Google
- [B] Microsoft
- [C] Meta
- [D] Amazon

Answer: Microsoft

In January 2026, Microsoft launched its second-generation in-house artificial intelligence (AI) processor called Maia 200. It builds on the first Maia chip that was introduced by Microsoft in 2023. The Maia 200 chip is manufactured by Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (TSMC). It uses advanced 3-nanometer (nm) process technology and includes high-bandwidth memory. The chip is currently operational at a Microsoft data centre in Iowa, marking its first live deployment. Microsoft plans to expand its deployment to other data centres. Maia 200 offers higher computing power, faster



memory bandwidth, and better energy efficiency.

235. Which state government launched the Samikshya portal for real-time monitoring of development projects?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Madhya Pradesh
- [D] Karnataka

Answer: Odisha

Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi launched the Samikshya portal for real-time monitoring of development projects. It tracks works funded under the State Finance Commission (SFC) and Central Finance Commission (CFC) grants. Citizens, officials, and elected representatives can monitor projects like roads, drinking water, sanitation, street lights, parks, and public utilities. It emphasizes equity, regional balance, and the needs of rural and urban bodies. The portal aims to improve transparency, accountability, and timely execution of grassroots projects.

236. What is the IUCN conservation status of 'Indo-Pacific leopard shark' that was recently seen in news?

- [A] Critically Endangered
- [B] Endangered
- [C] Vulnerable
- [D] Least Concern

Answer: Endangered

Thailand launched its first rewilding effort by releasing a young Indo-Pacific leopard shark near Maiton Island. Indo-Pacific leopard sharks are also called zebra sharks due to their changing spotted or striped patterns with age. They are slow-swimming reef sharks found in tropical coastal waters of the Indo-Pacific. It is classified as Endangered, according to the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN).

237. Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana (PMKSY) is implemented by which ministry?

- [A] Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare
- [B] Ministry of Food Processing Industries
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer: Ministry of Food Processing Industries

The Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI) implements the Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana (PMKSY), a Central Sector Umbrella scheme. As of 31 December 2025, 1,607 projects have been approved under PMKSY, with 1,196 completed/operational and 411 under implementation. Delays in implementation are mainly due to non-receipt of statutory clearances from authorities like Revenue, Town Planning, Electricity, Water, Pollution Control Board, and Licensing Authorities. Funds are released only after submission of required documents and fulfillment of all criteria under the scheme guidelines.



238. E-Shram portal is primarily designed for which group of workers?

- [A] Migrant workers
- [B] Unorganised Workers
- [C] Organized workers
- [D] None of the Above

Answer: Unorganised Workers

The Ministry of Labour and Employment launched the e-Shram portal (eshram.gov.in) on 26 August 2021 to create a National Database of Unorganised Workers (NDUW) including platform and migrant workers. The portal registers unorganised workers and issues a Universal Account Number (UAN) on a self-declaration basis. NITI Aayog estimated 7.7 million workers in 2020-21, rising to 23.5 million by 2029-30. Budget 2025-26 includes identity cards and Ayushman Bharat - Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY) healthcare coverage. This information was provided by Minister of State for Labour and Employment, Sushri Shobha Karandlaje, in a written reply to a question in Rajya Sabha

239. The V-BAT autonomous unmanned aerial system (UAS) is developed by which country?

- [A] United States
- [B] Japan
- [C] India
- [D] China

Answer: United States

The Indian Army has officially selected the US-based firm Shield AI to supply its advanced V-BAT autonomous drones under an emergency procurement deal, marking a major step in adopting AI-driven warfare systems. This procurement is significant as it enables India to integrate Hivemind AI software, allowing sovereign development and control of autonomous military capabilities. The V-BAT autonomous unmanned aerial system (UAS) is developed and manufactured by Shield AI, a US-based defense technology company. The V-BAT is classified as a Group 3 Vertical Take-Off and Landing (VTOL) Unmanned Aircraft System (UAS) designed for long-endurance and high-risk missions.

240. Sunabeda Wildlife Sanctuary which was declared Maoist-free in January 2026, is located in which state?

- [A] Odisha
- [B] Gujarat
- [C] Rajasthan
- [D] Kerala

Answer: Odisha

The Sunabeda Wildlife Sanctuary in Nuapada district, Odisha was declared Maoist-free in January 2026, enabling improved wildlife monitoring and conservation activities. In the All-India Tiger Estimation exercise (data yet to be officially released), authorities estimate over 70 leopards, with 90% camera traps capturing leopard images. Nuapada district regularly reports human-leopard conflict, supporting evidence of a strong leopard presence. Reduced Maoist activity enabled camera trap installation across all sanctuary sectors for



the first time.

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